



CITY: PG 3

Khattar pushes for Bhalswa clean-up



NATION: PG 5

Shah: NSA Doval played key role in strengthening India's foreign policy



FILM: PG 12

'More things can happen career-wise'

CM launches 'Laxmi' portal



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Saturday launched the online portal for 'Delhi Laxmi Yojna' under which financial aid of Rs 2,500 per month will be given to women in the city.

"Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, which is a scheme that will provide economic empowerment to the sisters of Delhi. The government has allocated a budget of Rs 5,100 crore for this. The portal has started from today, and registration has also begun," Gupta said, addressing the public.

Continued on P4



NSA Doval architect of India's 'proactive deterrence' doctrine
Maharashtra CM

In today's paper

...

BUSINESS

PV SALES RISE 33% IN JULY 2

INTERNATIONAL

TRUMP THREATENS MORE STRIKES ON IRAN 2

CITY

MINOR RAPED BY FRIEND 3

NATION

FIR REGISTERED AGAINST ANIL AMBANI 5

SPORT

SILVER LINING FOR NEERAJ 7

Commercial LPG down Rs 192, ATF up Rs 5/litre

NEW DELHI: The prices of commercial LPG — used in establishments such as hotels and restaurants — were on Saturday cut by a steep Rs 192 per 19-kg cylinder while aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices were hiked by Rs 5 per litre in line with divergent trends in benchmark rates. While a 19-kg commercial LPG cylinder in Delhi now costs Rs 2,738 as against Rs 2,930 previously, ATF rates have been raised to Rs 115 per litre from Rs 110, according to price information from state-owned oil firms. This is the second straight monthly reduction in commercial LPG rates following a Rs 183.5 cut on July 1. In case of ATF, the revision reverses the reduction by a similar proportion that was effected on July 1.

See P2

ON THE MOVE



Camels being led across the Shastri Bridge over the Ganga River by their handlers, in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, on Saturday

SEVENTH BOXING GOLD FOR INDIA IN GLASGOW CWG

India packs a Golden punch

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GLASGOW/NEW DELHI: India won their seventh gold medal in Commonwealth Games boxing with Ankush Panghal beating Dimeji Shittu of England in the men's 80 kg final here on Saturday.

Ankush won in a 4-1 split decision against Shittu.

The other Indian gold winners were Sachin Siwach, Jaismine Lamboria, Preeti Pawar, Sakshi Chaudhary, Arundhati Choudhary and Priya Ghanghas, while Olympic medallist Lovlina Borgohain and Jadumani Singh settled for a silver each.

In the men's 60kg final, Sachin beat Tryagain Morning Ndevelo of Namibia in a dramatic bout. He made a remarkable comeback after he was behind his opponent in the first two rounds.

In the third and final round, Sachin forced a standing count against Ndevelo, resulting in a 3-2 split verdict win in favour of the Indian.

Olympic medallist Lovlina Borgohain settled for a silver after losing to Emma-Sue

HISTORIC HAUL...

» ANKUSH WON in a 4-1 split decision against Shittu

» THE OTHER INDIAN gold winners were Sachin Siwach, Jaismine Lamboria, Preeti Pawar, Sakshi Chaudhary, Arundhati Choudhary and Priya Ghanghas, while Olympic medallist Lovlina Borgohain and Jadumani Singh settled for a silver each

» IN THE WOMEN'S section, Jaismine took the first round by a split verdict after a close contest with both boxers challenging each other

» HOWEVER, JAISMINE won the second round by a unanimous verdict, having landed some hard blows on her opponents



Preeti Pawar clinches a gold medal after winning against Canada's Scarlett Delgado during the Women's 54kg boxing final at the Commonwealth Games 2026, in Glasgow, Scotland

PTI

Greentree of Australia in the women's 70kg final in a split 1-4 verdict.

Arundhati beat Chantelle Reid of England in the women's 70kg final in a unanimous 5-0 verdict.

Preeti claimed the gold with a dominant 5-0 victory over Canada's Scarlett Del-

gado in the women's 54kg before reigning world champion Jaismine clinched the yellow metal with the same scoreline against Northern Ireland's Michaela Walsh, who was the defending champion in the women's 57kg.

Sakshi then beat Ruby White of England in women's

51kg final 5-0 to win India's third boxing gold of the day.

It was a harder final bout for Priya who beat Marie-Bathoul Al-Ahmadih of Canada 4-1 in a split verdict in the women's 60kg. Jadumani lost a hard-fought contest 0-5 against Australia's Jye Dixon.

Continued on P4

PARA STARS REWRITE HISTORY

GLASGOW: Indian para sports athletes scripted history in the Glasgow Commonwealth Games as they equaled the haul of all the previous editions put together, winning seven medals, including one gold and silver on Saturday.

The 28-member Indian para sports contingent ended their campaign with seven medals -- 3 gold, 2 silver and 2 bronze. On Sunday, Indians will feature in track cycling and para track cycling events.

It is the best ever performance for Indian para sports in the Commonwealth Games.

Since the introduction of para-sports in the CWG in the 2002 edition in Manchester, India have won a total of seven medals -- one gold, two silver and four bronze. Before Glasgow, the 2022 Birmingham Games was

Continued on P4

ATTACK AT A BRICK KILN IN KULGAM

J&K: Terror bullets claim 2 migrant lives



Security forces cordon off the area after suspected militants shot dead two non-local workers in the Kellam area, in Kulgam on Saturday

ANI

MPOST BUREAU

SRINAGAR: Terrorists shot dead two migrant labourers from Chhattisgarh on Friday evening at a brick kiln in the Kellam area of south Kashmir's Kulgam district, officials said on Saturday.

Terrorists targeted the labourers at the brick kiln in the Kellam area of the south Kashmir district late on Friday evening, they said.

Officials said the two labourers were injured in the attack, and one of them -- identified as Deepak Ratray -- succumbed to his injuries before he could be taken to a hospital.

The other injured person -- Bopinder -- was first taken to GMC Anantnag and later referred to SKIMS Hospital in Soura, officials said, adding that he died during treatment. The workers were both in their twenties and hailed

KEY POINTS

» The attack follows closely on the heels of another incident less than 10 days ago, in which terrorists allegedly shot and killed a police officer in Anantnag town

» J&K CM Abdullah announces Rs 10L each for kin of 2 migrant labourers

» Chhattisgarh govt declares Rs 20 lakh aid for kin

from Chhattisgarh, officials said.

The attack follows closely on the heels of another incident less than 10 days ago, in which terrorists allegedly shot and killed a police officer in Anantnag town.

Continued on P4

Gross GST mop-up jumps 15.4% in July

Higher sales, imports fuel robust growth

NEW DELHI: Gross GST collections grew 15.4 per cent to over Rs 2.11 lakh crore in July on higher mop-up from sales and imports, reflecting sustained domestic consumption. Gross GST collections were Rs 1.83 lakh crore in July 2025 and Rs 1.95 lakh crore last month.

Tax collection from domestic transactions grew 10.1 per cent to over Rs 1.44 lakh crore, while gross revenues from imports were up 29 per cent to Rs 66,511 crore.

Deloitte India Partner M S Mani said the GST collection reflects continued economic

Tax collection from domestic transactions grew 10.1 per cent to over Rs 1.44 lakh crore

resilience despite challenges in the external environment.

"Steady growth in GST collections each month on domestic consumption indicates that overall domestic consumption is becoming largely insulated from seasonal variations and external headwinds," Mani said.

See P2

FIVE DISTRICTS REMAIN INUNDATED

Assam floods: 82 dead, 1.92L affected

MPOST BUREAU

GUWAHATI: Assam's Sivasagar, Golaghat, Jorhat, Nagaon and Charaideo districts continued to reel under flood, with 1.92 lakh people in the state still affected, while two fatalities took the death toll to 82, officials said on Saturday.

The flood situation has improved since Thursday, when more than two lakh people in eight districts were affected.

However, Dikhow and Dhansiri rivers were reported to be in "severe flood situation" at Sivasagar and Numaligarh in Golaghat, with the authorities urging the people to stay away.

Continued on P4



A little girl holds her younger sister, who stands on debris and thick mud, in Sivasagar on Saturday

ANI

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A girl, purported to be the same one who appeared in a viral video abusing Prime Minister Narendra Modi, issued an apology video on social media on Saturday saying she had been "influenced."

The girl, who said she is 15, said the viral clip was not posted by her and she was "extremely embarrassed and ashamed."

PTI could not independently verify the authenticity of the apology video.

Meanwhile, Modi, in a late-night video message, said it pained him that not only he but also his late mother had been subjected to "filthy abuses" at the Janar Mantar protest.

The "misguided children" should be forgiven and guided on the right path, he said. In the video, the girl said, "I went

Continued on P4

SAYS ANDHRA PRADESH POISED TO BE MANUFACTURING HUB

PM Modi inaugurates Bhogapuram airport

OUR CORRESPONDENT

VISAKHAPATNAM: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday highlighted Andhra Pradesh's growth prospects, saying global companies were increasingly looking to invest in the state, which is poised to emerge as a major manufacturing hub.

Addressing a public rally after inaugurating the airport at Bhogapuram and launching development projects worth Rs 18,000 crore, Modi said the airport would become the "runway" for Andhra Pradesh's development, particularly in the northern region.

The Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport has been built at a cost of over Rs 5,700 crore with an initial annual passenger handling capacity of six million, expandable to 40 million.



Developed by the GMR Group, the airport will commence commercial flight operations on August 17.

"Google has announced a \$15 billion AI and cloud infrastructure campus at Visakhapatnam. Many other global companies are also exploring

new opportunities. This will greatly benefit Andhra Pradesh and create opportunities for the country's youth," Modi said.

He said the Centre was backing a mega pharma park at Nakkapalli, which is being developed into a major

CLOSER LOOK

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» Developed by the GMR Group, the airport will commence commercial flight operations on August 17

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» Google has announced a \$15 billion AI and cloud infrastructure campus at Visakhapatnam. Many other global companies are also exploring new opportunities

pharmaceutical hub in the state.

The Centre and the Andhra Pradesh government are prioritising the blue economy, port development and industrial growth, he said, adding that the state was also making rapid strides in

Continued on P4

UPI hits record ₹29.9 lakh crore

NEW DELHI: Transactions through the popular Unified Payments Interface (UPI) again reached a record high of Rs 29.9 lakh crore in July, according to data released by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). UPI transactions touched a record high of Rs 29.9 lakh crore in May 2026.

As per the data released on Saturday, UPI transactions in volume terms were 23.66 billion in July, higher than 23.2 billion in May and 22.72 billion in June.

The value of transactions was at Rs 29.88 lakh crore in July against Rs 25.08 lakh crore in the same month a year ago, registering 19 per cent annual growth.

See P2

MARUTI, HYUNDAI LOG RECORD SALES

Passenger vehicle sales rise 33% to 4.7 lakh units in July

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Passenger vehicle dispatches in the domestic market are estimated to have risen 33 per cent to about 4.7 lakh units in July this year, riding on record volumes led by market leader Maruti Suzuki, along with Hyundai.

Homegrown majors Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra also clocked high double-digit growth as the passenger vehicle industry continued to ride on the wave of impetus from GST 2.0, reduced repo rates and income tax relief on income of up to Rs 12 lakh. "Industry (passenger vehicle sales) should be around 4.65 lakh to 4.7 lakh in July this year. In July last year, the industry was around 3.5 lakh, so it is almost a growth of 33 per cent," Maruti Suzuki India Ltd (MSIL) Senior Executive Officer, Marketing & Sales, Partho Banerjee, said.

About the growth drivers for the industry, he said GST 2.0, repo rate cuts, income tax relief to entry-level customers have continued to fuel sales since last year. "Fundamentally, these



three tailwinds are very much there," Banerjee noted.

For Maruti Suzuki, the market leader posted its best-ever passenger vehicle sales in the domestic market at 1,96,203 units last month as compared to 1,37,776 units in July 2025, a growth of 43.4 per cent. "The company has witnessed all-round growth across segments from entry-level small cars to SUVs in July," he said, adding that alternate fuel CNG models continue to have robust demand.

Hyundai Motor India Ltd (HMIL) also reported its best-ever domestic monthly sales

at 54,210 units in July, up 23.3 per cent from the same month last year. "Our highest-ever monthly volume since inception, underscores the immense trust consumers place in brand Hyundai," HMIL MD & CEO Tarun Garg said.

Similarly, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd (TMPVL) also reported a 58 per cent jump in domestic passenger vehicle (PV) sales at 62,611 units last month as compared to 39,521 units in July 2025.

Homegrown rival Mahindra & Mahindra posted a 20 per cent growth in utility vehicle sales in the domestic mar-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Maruti Suzuki posted its best-ever PV sales at 1,96,203 units in July against 1,37,776 units in July 2025, up by 43.4%
- » Hyundai Motor India also reported its best-ever domestic monthly sales at 54,210 units in July, up 23.3% from the same month last year

ket at 60,048 units last month as against 49,871 units in July 2025.

Honda Cars India Ltd said it recorded domestic sales growth of over 48 per cent, with 6,014 units sold during the month.

Toyota Kirloskar Motor reported a 5 per cent rise in domestic sales at 30,516 units in July 2026 as compared to 29,159 units in the same month last year.

Kia India also reported a 27.4 per cent rise in whole-sale dispatches at 28,200 units in July 2026 as compared to 22,135 units in the same month last year.

SBI Research raises India's Q1 FY27 GDP growth estimate to around 7%

The report said the growth estimate marks an improvement from the RBI's earlier projections, which were lowered because of geopolitical uncertainties

NEW DELHI: India's economy is likely to grow around 7 per cent in the first quarter of FY27, higher than earlier expectations, supported by stronger economic indicators, improved industrial activity and a recovery in exports, according to an SBI Research Pre-Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) report released on Saturday.

The report said the growth estimate marks an improvement from the Reserve Bank of India's earlier projections, which were lowered because of geopolitical uncertainties.

"In the last three policies, RBI downgraded Q1 FY27 GDP growth projection from 6.9 per cent to 6.6 per cent due to war in middle east. However, now we believe that situation has changed and Q1 growth print may be much better than anticipated," SBI Research said in its report. "Our preliminary estimate indicates that Q1 GDP may clock ~7.0 per cent growth." The report attributed the improved outlook to a broad-based pickup in high-frequency indicators during the



April-June quarter.

According to the report, domestic passenger vehicle sales grew 24.1 per cent year-on-year in June, electricity demand increased 11.5 per cent, exports rose 15.5 per cent, industrial credit expanded 19.2 per cent and the Index of Industrial Production (IIP) grew 7.3 per cent, indicating stronger economic momentum during the quarter.

SBI Research also noted that the global environment remains uncertain, but India's domestic economy has shown resilience. "Global economy

remains uncertain amidst the West Asia crisis, with diverging trends visible across countries. US economy slowed down unexpectedly in Apr-Jun 2026 quarter. India is showing signs of GDP growth coming above expectations..touching approx. 7 per cent in Apr-Jun quarter," the report said.

The report said the recovery in monsoon conditions could further support economic activity in the coming months.

It noted that July's surplus rainfall reduced the nationwide rainfall deficit to about 13 per cent, while reservoir

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Report attributed the improved outlook to a broad-based pickup in high-frequency indicators in Q1FY27
- » SBI Research also noted that the global environment remains uncertain, but India's domestic economy has shown resilience

levels have returned to normal and kharif sowing is only 4.7 per cent lower than last year's level, pointing to the prospects of a better harvest. "Kharif sowing (so far) is only 4.7 per cent lower than the 2025 levels indicating better harvest and subsequently minimal/no impact on food inflation going forward," the report said.

Despite the stronger growth outlook, SBI Research expects the RBI to keep interest rates unchanged at the upcoming MPC meeting, citing elevated inflation risks and external uncertainties.

UPI transactions reach record high of ₹29.9 lakh crore in July

NEW DELHI: Transactions through the popular UPI again reached a record high of Rs 29.9 lakh crore in July, according to data released by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). UPI transactions touched a record high of Rs 29.9 lakh crore in May 2026.

As per the data released on Saturday, UPI transactions in volume terms were 23.66 billion

in July, higher than 23.2 billion in May and 22.72 billion in June.

The value of transactions was at Rs 29.88 lakh crore in July against Rs 25.08 lakh crore in the same month a year ago, registering 19 per cent annual growth. UPI transactions in volume terms were 19.46 billion in June 2026.

"UPI continues to strengthen the foundation of

India's digital payments ecosystem. In July 2026, it processed 23.66 billion transactions worth Rs 29.88 lakh crore, reaffirming its role as the preferred mode of payment for millions of Indians," PayNearby MD and CEO Anand Kumar Bajaj said. As UPI adoption deepens, the focus must remain on building trust, awareness & ease of usage at the grassroots, he said

Govt cuts commercial LPG prices by ₹192

NEW DELHI: The prices of commercial LPG — used in establishments such as hotels and restaurants — were on Saturday cut by a steep Rs 192 per 19-kg cylinder while ATF prices were hiked by Rs 5 per litre.

While a 19-kg commercial LPG cylinder in Delhi now costs Rs 2,738 as against Rs 2,930 previously, aviation turbine fuel rates have been

raised to Rs 115 per litre from Rs 110, according to price information from state-owned oil firms.

This is the second straight monthly reduction in commercial LPG rates following a Rs 183.5 cut on July 1.

In case of ATF, the revision reverses the reduction by a similar proportion that was effected on July 1.

Gross GST mop-up grows 15.4% to over ₹2.11 lakh crore in July

NEW DELHI: Gross Goods and Services Tax (GST) collections grew 15.4 per cent to over Rs 2.11 lakh crore in July on higher mop-up from sales and imports, reflecting sustained domestic consumption.

Gross GST collections were Rs 1.83 lakh crore in July 2025 and Rs 1.95 lakh crore last month.

Tax collection from domes-

tic transactions grew 10.1 per cent to over Rs 1.44 lakh crore, while gross revenues from imports were up 29 per cent to Rs 66,511 crore.

Deloitte India Partner M S Mani said the Goods and Services Tax collection reflects continued economic resilience despite challenges in the external environment.

"Steady growth in GST col-

lections each month on domestic consumption indicates that overall domestic consumption is becoming largely insulated from seasonal variations and external headwinds," Mani said, adding that Goods and Services Tax collections in July increased in major manufacturing states like Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka, and Telangana.

World

Spain to fence Ceuta border after deadly frontier rush killed 67

'The death toll has climbed to 67, including some who drowned and others who were killed in a stampede to cross a breakwater barrier'

CEUTA (Spain): Spain announced it was installing a 500-metre-long (1,600-foot) containment barrier on the sea border between its North African territory of Ceuta and neighbouring Morocco after between 50,000 and 60,000 migrants breached the frontier earlier this week.

The death toll has climbed to 67, including some who drowned and others who were killed in a stampede to cross a breakwater barrier, the Spanish government said Saturday.

A handful of exhausted migrants who swam to Ceuta's urban Tarajal beach Saturday morning were met by soldiers who escorted them back across the border. Spain's interior ministry says the majority of those who entered the Spanish territory in North Africa have already returned to Morocco.

"We are relentless against those who break the law," Spanish Interior Minister Fernando Grande-Marlaska told journalists in Ceuta on Saturday.



Migrants run from Spanish police officers after crossing from Morocco into the Spanish enclave of Ceuta

Questioned how this massive border breach could have happened given the heavy security on both sides of the border and whether Morocco posed a threat to Ceuta, Marlaska defended the government in Rabat.

"The events require an evaluation by Spain and Morocco," he said. But it was the cooperation with its neighbours that

allowed Spain "to revert the situation in 24 hours."

"Morocco is not a threat to Ceuta, or to the rest of Spain. It is a reliable partner," Marlaska emphasized.

After days of chaos and streets packed with people who had hoped for a better life in Spain, residents of Ceuta woke up Saturday to an uneasy calm.

Even so, security in the

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Spain's interior ministry says majority of those who entered the Spanish territory in North Africa have already returned to Morocco
- » "We are relentless against those who break the law," Spanish Interior Minister Fernando Grande-Marlaska said on Saturday

autonomous city of 84,000 remained bruised.

"Life in this city has been disrupted as a result of the border incident," said Ceuta's President Juan Jesús Vivas.

"The return of people has begun satisfactorily but the process must be completed," he said. "The city has not yet returned to normal."

In the Moroccan city of

Tangier, about 75 kilometres (46 miles) west of Ceuta, the main railway station was busy with people returning from Ceuta or the border. Some slept on the ground, exhausted, as passersby watched from a distance.

"I tried to cross, but I failed. I stayed near the border with Ceuta for two days, but I couldn't find anything to eat," said Abdalah, an aspiring migrant who asked that his last name not be published out of fear of retaliation for trying to cross illegally.

On the road leading to the Moroccan town of Fnideq, which borders Ceuta, many migrants were seen walking toward the fence, some barefoot, apparently hoping to try their luck. Taxi drivers and bus operators were refusing to take them, fearing retaliation from authorities. Police officers were deployed along the road, stopping and checking every vehicle heading toward Fnideq.

Russia's missile and drone strikes on Kyiv, kills at least 9

KYIV: At least nine people were killed and 22 civilians injured in the Ukrainian capital Kyiv after Russia launched an intense barrage of ballistic missiles and drones overnight into Saturday, authorities said.

A five-story residential building in the city's Solomianskyi District was damaged by falling debris and a fire broke out. Rescue workers evacuated 35 people from the upper floors of the building and two people died, with eight reported injured including two children, according to Ukraine's state emergency service.

In the Darnytskyi District of Kyiv, seven people were killed and another 14 injured after the attack caused fires and damage to houses, vehicles, an administrative and non-residential building, the emergency services said.

Elsewhere, emergency workers extinguished a fire in a non-residential building in the capital's Shevchenkivskyi district. There was no additional information about earlier reports by the district mayor that people were trapped in another residential building.

Damage to commercial and residential buildings was reported in two other city districts. The Ukrainian leader late



Emergency services personnel work to extinguish a fire following Russian missile attacks in Kyiv, Ukraine on Saturday

Friday said he spoke to U.S. Vice President JD Vance and discussed a meeting with President Donald Trump earlier this week in Washington, which Zelenskyy described as "positive and productive."

"The Russian air strikes on our country continue and air defense, specifically interceptors for Patriot systems against ballistic missiles, remains a top priority," Zelenskyy said Friday in a post on Telegram.

At a NATO summit in Ankara in July, Trump said the U.S. would give Ukraine a license to make Patriot systems but he appeared to move away from that commitment on Fri-

day during a Cabinet meeting at the presidential retreat in Camp David, Maryland, saying he had not yet made a final decision on the matter.

Saturday's attack on Kyiv came just two days after a large-scale Russian ballistic missile and drone attack across Ukraine killed 10 civilians and wounded more than 50 others and saw a Russian missile enter Polish airspace.

From a basement shelter where she was taking cover as a second air alarm sounded for another wave, Liudmyla Nakonechna, 64, described how she was woken by loud explosions at 1:30 a.m.

US Prez Trump threatens more strikes on Iran

CAIRO: US President Donald Trump threatened more strikes on Iran as the United States presses for the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz.

Hours later on Saturday, Kuwait said it responded to a new round of drone attacks from Iran while a tanker was struck in the strategic waterway.

Meanwhile, Israel carried out heavy strikes on the Gaza Strip after the Palestinian mili-

tant group Hamas agreed to disarm.

Speaking to reporters Friday during a meeting with members of his Cabinet at the Camp David presidential retreat in Maryland, Trump said "we just want to win" in Iran and signalled that he expected US military action to continue for some time.

He said the US will hit Iran "very hard" until they can't take

it anymore.

Later that day, White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt expressed the US administration's frustration anew, charging that Tehran last month signed a memorandum of understanding with the US on a truce but then quickly "broke it, shot at commercial ships, and killed American soldiers."

"President Trump is not

going to stand by and allow this terrorist behavior to occur," Leavitt said in a statement on Friday evening. "Iran will continue to pay until they come to the table in, what President Trump deems, a meaningful way."

Kuwait's military said Saturday that its forces were responding to drone attacks, which were part of Iran's assaults on the country.

China issues new rules for shoal in South China Sea

BEIJING: China on Saturday issued management measures for the Huangyan Dao National Nature Reserve in the disputed South China Sea, a move likely to further escalate its maritime row with the Philippines, which has counterclaims over the shoal.

The measures are a key step in safeguarding the diversity, stability and sustainability of the Huangyan Dao natural ecosystem, an official announcement

said here tonight. Under the rules, a routine patrol system will be established to promptly investigate and handle violations in accordance with the law.

Violators will be held accountable under relevant laws and regulations, state-run Xinhua news agency quoted the rules jointly issued by the Ministry of Natural Resources, the National Forestry and Grassland Administration, the China Coast Guard, and the Hainan

provincial government.

Without prior approval, any activities such as fishing, mining, and the extraction of corals, coral reefs or giant clams that damage rare marine species and the natural ecosystem are prohibited, it said.

No individual or organisation may enter the reserve, except as otherwise provided by laws and regulations or for activities organised for conservation and management purposes, it said.

Earlier, the PLA Southern Theatre Command (STC) conducted a joint naval air training exercise focusing on multiple realistic training subjects in the territorial sea and airspace of Huangyan Dao and its surrounding areas on Saturday, the Chinese military said.

China claims most of the SCS as its own. The Philippines, Vietnam, Malaysia, Brunei and Taiwan have counterclaims over the area.

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Khattar pushes for Bhalswa clean-up

Directs MCD to expedite legacy waste remediation

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal Khattar on Saturday reviewed the status of legacy waste remediation work at Bhalswa dumpsite and asked MCD to speed up processing of new wastes to clear the landfill scientifically

Manohar Lal reviewed the progress of remediation work from the dumpsite, along with the MCD Commissioner and senior officials of the MoHUA and Department of Urban Development. As per the data provided by MCD, 99.07 lakh metric tonnes of legacy waste has been cleared at Bhalswa dumpsite as on 31st July. The municipal body has informed the minister that the remaining waste mound at the site would be cleared by 15 th October 2026, while the total waste generated till March 2026 that has been accumulated at Bhalswa dumpsite would be processed by 31st December 2026.

During his review, Manohar Lal directed MCD to fast track the recently awarded project for processing of fresh wastes received at the dumpsite, to ensure that no more waste is generated and to manage the



Manohar Lal Khattar during the visit

Highlights

» Manohar Lal directed MCD to fast track the recently awarded project for processing of fresh wastes received at the dumpsite

» “The Union Government is committed to the time bound clearances of the legacy waste as well as the transformation of the landfill sites,” he added

new wastes scientifically. “The Union Government is committed to the time bound clearances of the legacy waste as well as the transformation of the landfill sites,” he added. The visit of the Union Minister MoHUA, signifies the Ministry’s commitment towards monitoring of the remediation works at all the landfill sites and follow up the works of the urban local bodies for abiding by the timelines for the clearance of legacy waste and the betterment of the environment in the national capital.

Minor alleges repeated rape; POCSO invoked

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A POCSO case was registered after a 17-year-old girl from Delhi was allegedly raped multiple times by her friend at a hotel in Gurugram, police said on Saturday. The matter came to light when the girl got pregnant, they said, adding that an FIR has been registered under Section 64(1) of the BNS and Section 6 of the POCSO Act at DLF Phase 1 police station. According to the police, the

The girl is a native of Bihar’s Samastipur and resides with her family in Vikas Nagar

girl is a native of Bihar’s Samastipur and currently resides with her family in a rented accommodation in Delhi’s Vikas Nagar. She had known the accused since 2025. It is alleged that between January 1 and March 22, 2026, the accused took her multiple times to a hotel in Sikanderpur, located on MG Road in Gurugram,

where she was allegedly raped, they added. Recently, upon falling ill, she was taken to a hospital by her family. A medical examination confirmed that she was pregnant. As she was a minor, the hospital informed the police. Subsequently, a ‘Zero FIR’ was registered at Delhi’s Ranhola police station, and

the case was transferred to the DLF Phase-1 police station, they said. A case has been registered under Section 64(1) of the BNS and Section 6 of the POCSO Act at DLF Phase-1 police station, they added. “We are investigating the matter and hotel records are being scrutinised. Raids are being conducted at potential hideouts to arrest the accused. The accused will be arrested soon”, said a senior police officer.

Govt school students head to Germany, Japan on study tours

NEW DELHI: Twenty-nine students from Delhi government schools have embarked on an academic journey to Germany and Japan under the Delhi government’s APAL programme and various international scholarship initiatives. Education Minister Ashish Sood flagged off the second batch of CM SHRI students and interacted with them before their departure, wishing them success and encouraging them to make the country proud, according to a statement.

It said the APAL (Ausbildung Programm fur Auszubildende in Deutschland) programme has expanded opportunities for students from Delhi government schools to pursue education and vocational training abroad. Last year, 14 students travelled to Germany under the programme, while this year the number has increased to 24.

The Delhi government’s APAL education initiative is an international partnership with Germany providing dual vocational training for public school students. It allows selected Class 12 graduates from state-run schools to complete a 3 to 3.5-year technical training and work program in Germany.

The students travelling to Germany will undergo the country’s dual vocational training programme. After completing German language and intercultural training, they will undertake a two to three-and-a-half-year programme that combines classroom education with paid industry training and includes a monthly stipend, it read.

Apart from the APAL programme, two students have secured scholarships for higher studies at the Fukuoka Institute of Technology in Japan, one student has gained admission to RWTH Aachen University in Germany.

DTC cluster bus crushes woman; driver arrested

NEW DELHI: A 60-year-old woman was killed after a DTC cluster bus ran over her near the Pooth Kalan bus stand on Saturday here, triggering protests by her family members and locals who briefly blocked the road and pelted stones before police pacified them, an officer said.

Police apprehended the bus driver Rajesh, seized the vehicle, registered a case and initiated separate legal action against unidentified people



who allegedly vandalised the bus after the accident. The deceased was identified as Indira, wife of Ramesh and a resident of Sultanpuri. According to police, a PCR

call regarding the accident at the Pooth Kalan bus stand on Kanjhawala Road in outer Delhi was received at the Sultanpuri police station at 11:05 am. “When a police team reached the spot, Indira was found lying unconscious near the rear wheel of a DTC cluster bus on route number 114A from Azadpur to Auchandi Border,” a senior police officer said. She was transported to San-

jay Gandhi Memorial Hospital in Mangolpuri, where doctors declared her brought dead, the officer said. Police said after the victim’s death, her family members and residents blocked the road near the accident site, causing temporary traffic disruption. During the commotion, some unidentified people allegedly pelted stones at the DTC cluster bus involved in the accident and damaged its window panes, they said.

Going bananas for sustainable leather

DU students develop vegan leather using banana peels



ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Students of University of Delhi have developed an eco-friendly, vegan leather-like material using discarded banana peels, turning agricultural waste into a potential sustainable alternative to conventional animal leather.

The innovation seeks to address two concerns simultaneously the growing volume of agricultural waste and the environmental impact associated with traditional leather production. According to details shared by Delhi University, the banana peels are processed using sustainable techniques to create a material that is durable, flexible and resembles leather.

From waste to wear The process involves converting discarded banana peels, which would otherwise contribute to organic waste, into a value-added material. The initiative is based on the principles of a circular economy, in which waste is converted into useful products rather than being discarded. The material could potentially be used in a range of lifestyle and fashion products, including bags, backpacks, wallets, belts, footwear, fashion accessories and other products.

Sustainable fashion The development is being positioned as a possible alternative to animal leather, with the material offering an eco-friendly and cruelty-free option for the fashion indus-

In Short

- » The eco-friendly material aims to reduce agricultural waste and promote sustainable fashion
- » The student-led project showcases a biodegradable, cruelty-free alternative to animal leather

try. It could also help reduce dependence on animal-based leather while promoting the use of agricultural waste in manufacturing. The initiative highlights the potential for student-led research and innovation to contribute to sustainable product development. With growing interest in environmentally responsible materials, alternatives made from agricultural waste are being explored as a way to reduce the environmental footprint of consumer products. **Bright future** The innovation could also encourage entrepreneurship among students by creating opportunities to develop commercially viable products from locally available waste materials. If scaled up successfully, such technologies could find applications in sustainable fashion and other consumer sectors. The initiative also reflects the increasing emphasis on green technology and waste utilisation in institutions.

Woman slit lover’s throat for ‘putting off’ marriage; arrested

FARIDABAD: A woman allegedly slit the throat of her lover, a Faridabad-based house painter, after he resisted pressure from her to get married, police said on Saturday. She was arrested on Friday night, a day after the man’s decomposed body was found in her rented room in Domka Mohalla of Anangpur village in Faridabad, they said.

Anita (33), who is from Satna village of Rewa district in Madhya Pradesh, was produced in a city court on Saturday and was sent to police custody for two days.

Police said that during interrogation, Anita allegedly said she was pressuring Sadaqat to marry her but he kept putting it off. On July 25, she allegedly

Both were previously married and Anita had been abandoned by her husband

invited Sadaqat to her room and gave him alcohol. Late at night, when Sadaqat was drunk and asleep, she allegedly slit his throat with a knife and killed him. She allegedly locked the room from the outside and fled, they said. Sadaqat and Anita both worked at a gated residential society; he was a house painter and she was a cleaner. Both were previously married and Anita had been abandoned by her husband. They were sharing a room

in Anangpur village before the landlord asked Anita to vacate the room after learning of their relationship, police said. She then rented another room in Domka Mohalla of Anangpur village around 15 days ago, and Sadaqat frequently visited her there, according to the complaint filed by Sadaqat’s brother, Nazakat Ali, who suspected Anita to be behind the murder. Nazakat alleged that on July 23, Sadaqat left home saying he was going to Aligarh but never returned. His mobile phone also became unreachable. When Nazakat contacted Anita, she allegedly denied that Sadaqat had visited her. On Thursday, police received information about a body in a house in Domka mohalla.

MCD Commissioner inspects water logging-prone Kutub Road stretch

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on Saturday inspected the water-logging-prone stretch near Teliwara Akhara on Kutub Road in Sadar Bazar and directed officials to ensure a permanent solution to the problem through inter-departmental

coordination. The inspection was attended by local councillor and Zone Chairman Usha Sharma, Deputy Commissioner Kanika, and officials from the MCD, Delhi Jal Board and Delhi Metro. During the inspection, officials reviewed the drainage arrangements in the area. The Deputy Commissioner said plastic waste and polythene

had earlier accumulated inside a main manhole, obstructing the flow of water. A grill cover has now been installed to prevent solid waste from entering the manhole. Khirwar also inspected another manhole and directed officials to replace its solid cover with a grill to facilitate faster drainage during heavy rainfall.



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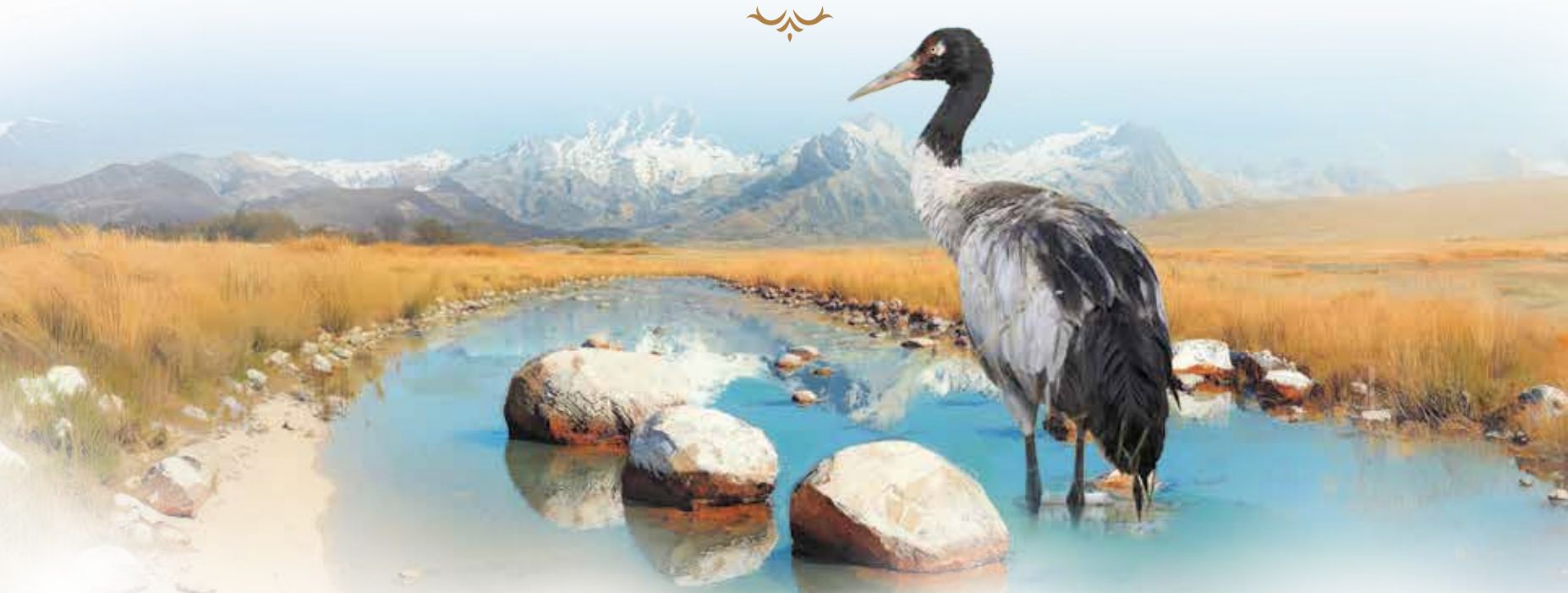
BLACK NECKED CRANE

FESTIVAL OF LADAKH

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VISIT LADAKH FOR A RARE BIRDWATCHING EXPERIENCE



Safeguarding the Sacred Wings | Preserving the Pristine Nature | Honouring the Spirit of Ladakh

FESTIVAL HIGHLIGHTS

Crane Conference

Black-necked Crane Habitat Tours

Guided Bird Watching

Wildlife Photography

Wetland Nature Walks

Cultural Performances

Local Handicraft Market

Conservation Exhibition

Department of Forest, Ecology & Environment Union Territory of Ladakh

Scan For

 Conference

 Festival

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NEET-PG 2026

Candidates to get centres closer to home, test city info 3 weeks in advance

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a series of changes for the NEET-PG to be held later this year, the Centre will expand the choice of test locations, give candidates more time to plan travel to their examination cities, and give them more time per question in the test.

The reforms are aimed at making the process more convenient for National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test for Postgraduate (NEET-PG) candidates, according to the Union health ministry.

“The end-to-end question paper preparation and delivery process has been further reinforced through multiple layers of encryption, secure offline preparation, time-bound finalisation of the question paper shortly before the examination, and controlled digital decryption only at the scheduled commencement of the test,” the

Highlights

» The reforms are aimed at making the process more convenient for National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test for Postgraduate (NEET-PG) candidates, according to the Union health ministry

» The National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences has also operationalised a dedicated email address for reporting impersonation, touting and other unfair practices

ministry said in a statement.

The National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) has also operationalised a dedicated email address for reporting impersonation, touting and other unfair practices while issuing regular advisories to candidates to promote awareness and vigilance.

Under the revised system, candidates will indicate three state preferences for their examination centre, with their correspondence state being the

mandatory first preference, enabling allotment of centres closer to their place of residence, the ministry said.

In another key change, candidates will be informed of their allotted test city nearly three weeks before the August 30 examination, giving them more time to plan travel and accommodation, it said.

The NBEMS has also rationalised the examination pattern to 180 questions to be answered in 210 minutes, allowing candidates more time

per question while retaining the overall duration of the test, it said.

The ministry added that to strengthen the integrity of the examination process, Aadhaar-based authentication has been introduced during both the application process and on the examination day.

Iris-based biometric verification will be used wherever fingerprint authentication is unsuccessful, it said.

Union Health Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda on Saturday reviewed the preparedness for NEET-PG 2026 and directed all agencies to ensure the examination is conducted in a smooth, secure, transparent and technology-enabled manner. He assessed the readiness of NBEMS, technology partners and other stakeholders and stressed that every effort must be made to ensure a fair and candidate-friendly examination.

A total of 2,73,183 candidates have registered for NEET-PG 2026, an increase of over 12.5 per cent compared to last year. The examination will be conducted in a single shift across around 340 cities and more than 1,300 examination centres.

Comprehensive security arrangements have been put in place for the examination, including advance sealing and verification of examination centres, CCTV surveillance, biometric authentication, candidate frisking, deployment of signal jammers, dynamic comput, live monitoring through central and regional command centres, and real-time supervision by independent observers and appraisers.

More than 60,000 examination functionaries will be deployed to ensure the smooth conduct of the examination, the ministry said.

Heavy rain batters Kerala: Six dead, rescue operations continue

OUR CORRESPONDENT

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: Heavy rains lashed several parts of Kerala on Saturday, triggering landslides, inundating low-lying areas, swelling rivers and dams, and prompting authorities to launch large-scale rescue and evacuation operations in affected regions.

A statement from the CMO said six people were killed in rain-related incidents across the state. Four of the deaths occurred in separate landslides in Idukki and Kottayam districts, where several others were rescued.

Search operations for the six missing persons continued with personnel from the National Disaster Response Force, Fire and Rescue Services, police, the Coast Guard, the local administration, public representatives and residents participating in the efforts, the statement said.

The statement said 65 relief camps had been opened across the state, providing shelter to 1,465 people.

Chief Minister V D Satheesan said 17 houses had been



Rescue personnel and people during a rescue operation following a landslide due to rain triggered floods, in Kottayam, Kerala, Saturday PTI

destroyed and another 127 had suffered partial damage in rain-related incidents.

Two separate fatal landslides were reported in Idukki district. The deceased was identified as Sumathi (65), a resident of Adoormala near Kudayathoor in Idukki district. Her husband, Ravi, and their son, Ratheesh, were rescued and admitted to hospital, officials said.

In another incident, Prabhakaran Nair (77) of Vaikom died after a landslide hit the house of his relative in the Vagamon area of Idukki district.

A youth died, and his mother

was trapped under debris after a landslide at Payyanthottam in Poonjar in Kottayam district.

The deceased was identified as Josephine, son of Johnny. His mother, Rejina Johny (46), was trapped under debris, officials said.

Following the landslides and flooding, Satheesan directed ministers in charge of rain-hit districts to camp in their respective districts and coordinate rescue and relief operations as heavy rain continued across the state. He reviewed the situation with ministers and district collectors.

Counterfeit combat cloth network exposed in Rajasthan, over 1,000 metres seized

NEW DELHI: An operation jointly undertaken by the Indian Army and the Rajasthan police has uncovered an alleged racket responsible for the manufacture and supply of fake Army-pattern combat uniform fabric in Sriganganagar district of Rajasthan, bringing back into the limelight the issue of misuse of military uniforms and its national security consequences.

More than 1,000 meters of Army-pattern combat uniforms have been seized during raids conducted on July 30 at various shops in the Sriganga-



nagar district. This particular raid was conducted by intelligence branches of the Army in tandem with Rajasthan Police, following weeks of covert investigation into the source of similar counterfeit material seized in Uttar Pradesh in the first half of

the year. The development highlights the ongoing challenge for security forces to stop the illegal manufacture and distribution of clothing patterned like military uniforms, which criminals, anti-nationalists, or impersonators may use to their advantage to infiltrate sensitive places.

The probe was launched after the Indian Army discovered fake combat fabric in Bareilly in June. The initial forensic and intelligence report revealed that the origin of the fabric was a manufacturer from Sriganganagar district of Rajasthan.

Based on the information, a covert probe was launched by Army intelligence to trace the manufacturing and distributing network.

It was reportedly established that a local company was one of the critical points of the supply chain. Sources linked to the investigations revealed that the company was believed to be dealing in counterfeit Army-style combat fabric which it supplied to retailers not only in the town of Sriganganagar, but also in Lalgahar Jattan, Suratgarh, and adjacent markets. MPOST

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A group of paramilitary officers have approached the Supreme Court challenging certain sections of the newly-enacted CAPFs (General Administration) Act claiming this law will continue to restrict their career progression, official sources said on Saturday.

The matter has been listed by the apex court for hearing in the first week of August, according to court documents. Officers and their legal rep-

resentatives told news agency that a batch of writ petitions have been filed by about 3,000 cadre officers drawn from the five Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) like the CRPF, BSF, ITBP, CISF and SSB.

They said the petitions have been filed under Article 32 of the Constitution that allows citizens to approach the Supreme Court to enforce their Fundamental Rights.

Petitioners said they were “forced” to move the apex court as they feel justice was not served to them by the new

Act and the directives of the Supreme Court’s May, 2025 verdict were not implemented.

We feel that the latest Act will not resolve the huge stagnation and career progression of CAPF cadre officers, they said.

The petitioners include gallantry medal winners and a few women officers.

The officers have sought declaration of the sections 3 and 4 of the CAPF (General Administration) Act, 2026 as “ultra vires” the Constitution and that the Union gov-

ernment should be directed to give “full effect” to the May, 2025 judgement of the Supreme Court.

The Supreme Court, on May 23 last year, said that the deputation of Indian Police Service (IPS) officers up to the rank of Inspector General (IG) in the CAPFs should be “progressively reduced” over a period of two years in order to give more opportunities to cadre officers whose delayed promotions can “adversely” impact the morale of these forces.

From Page 1 Assam floods

‘Laxmi’ portal

“I think almost 500 sisters have successfully filled their forms on this,” she added.

The Delhi Cabinet headed by Gupta on Tuesday passed the scheme under which eligible women will receive Rs 2,500 every month. The scheme was a key poll promise of the BJP in Assembly polls held last year.

According to the scheme guidelines approved by the cabinet, women, aged between 21 and 60, whose family income is up to Rs 2.50 lakh per annum, will be eligible to apply.

Women already receiving benefits under any other financial assistance scheme or pension, taxpayers, government employees, women with more than three living children, families with annual electricity consumption exceeding 2,400 units, will not be eligible for the scheme.

Families with any member having a government job, a criminal case, and those owning four-wheelers will also be excluded from the scheme’s ambit.

Of the total dole, Rs 1,500 will be kept in a fixed deposit with a three-year lock-in period, reducing the in-hand sum to Rs 1,000.

Leak it

issuing fake admit cards.

The 2024 law was brought in when the government faced raging paper leak controversies.

Before the 2024 legislation, there was no specific substantive law to deal with unfair means adopted or offences committed by various entities involved in the conduct of public examinations by the Central government and its agencies.

The previous Act aimed to prevent unfair means in public examinations conducted by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC), the Staff Selection Commission (SSC), the Railways, banking recruitment examinations and the National Testing Agency (NTA), among others.

Under the amended law, all the states and UTs will be directed to set up fast-track courts, which will complete the trial within three months of filing of the chargesheet.

Assam floods

Officials said that around 13,000 people were sheltered in 54 relief camps. Another 26 relief distribution centres were open, catering to 5,384 people. Multiple agencies, including the NDRF and SDRF, were carrying out relief operations.

The state government has decided to approach insurance companies and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) for expeditious disposal of claims and providing a moratorium to their customers from these areas.

It was also focusing on swift assessment of damage so that funds for repair are disbursed at the earliest.

Officials said two more deaths have been reported in the floods this year, one each from Sivasagar and Charaideo districts, taking the toll to 82.

Sivasagar, Golaghat, Jorhat, Nagaon and Charaideo districts continued to reel under the deluge.

The number of affected people was at 1,92,799, with Charaideo being the worst-hit with 77,456 people hit by the deluge, followed by 63,492 in Sivasagar and 34,067 in Jorhat.

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said the state cabinet on Friday decided to convene a meeting with private and government insurance companies on August 5 to urge them to expeditiously settle claims against insured damaged vehicles, livestock and other properties.

The government will also meet the NBFCs the same day, requesting them to grant a moratorium to borrowers from these four districts.

The announcement came a day after the chief minister chaired a special meeting of the State Level Bankers’ Committee (SLBC), in which it was decided that a six-month moratorium would be offered to all flood-affected people in four districts to repay loans.

The measures have been announced for the worst-hit four districts of Sivasagar, Charaideo, Jorhat and Golaghat.

In a social media post, Sarma said that over Rs 41 crore has been approved under the PM Surya Ghar pending state subsidy for the flood-affected areas.

“As floods affect four districts of Assam, our government stands firmly with every affected family. Along with other relief and assistance, we have approved Rs 41.67

crore under the PM Surya Ghar pending state subsidy for 9,289 beneficiaries in the affected areas,” he said.

Sarma added that the Power Department has been directed to ensure that Assam Power Distribution Corporation Ltd transfers the amount directly to their bank accounts by Tuesday.

J&K

Before this, two labourers were killed here in the summer capital of Jammu and Kashmir in 2024.

On February 7, 2024, two non-local workers from Punjab, Amritpal Singh and Rohit Masih, were shot dead by a terrorist in the Shaheed Gunj area of Srinagar.

Meanwhile, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah announced an ex-gratia relief of Rs 10 lakh each for the kin of two migrant labourers.

The amount is in addition to the immediate assistance of Rs 6 lakh each announced by the district administration.

“The chief minister has strongly condemned the dastardly killing of two labourers in Kulgam and expressed profound grief over the loss of innocent lives.

“He announced an ex gratia relief of Rs 10 lakh each from the Chief Minister’s Relief Fund for the next of kin of the deceased. This will be in addition to the immediate assistance of Rs 6 lakh each to be provided by the district administration,” the chief minister’s office (CMO) said in a post on X.

Abdullah also conveyed his heartfelt condolences to the bereaved families and reaffirmed that the government stood firmly with them during this difficult time, it added.

Chhattisgarh government also announced an ex gratia of Rs 20 lakh each for the families of two migrant workers.

Condemning the attack, Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai said targeting innocent civilians is a crime against humanity and such acts of terror have no place in a civilised society.

“The Chhattisgarh government stands firmly with the bereaved families in this hour of grief,” he said while announcing the financial assistance of Rs 20 lakh each to the next of kin of the deceased workers.

Sai said he has directed senior state officials to coordinate with

their counterparts in Jammu and Kashmir immediately after receiving information about the incident to ensure necessary assistance.

He said a nodal officer will be appointed by the Chhattisgarh government to coordinate with the Jammu and Kashmir administration and oversee the process of extending all possible support to the affected families.

National Conference president Farooq Abdullah called for an investigation into the killing of the two migrant labourers and asked why such incidents happen whenever his party demands restoration of statehood to Jammu and Kashmir.

“I regret it. We do not even know who killed them and how they were killed. There should be an investigation, a fair probe into who the killers are,” Abdullah told reporters in north Kashmir’s Baramulla district.

The three-time chief minister also questioned the timing of such incidents in the Valley.

PM Modi

sectors such as semiconductors, information technology and innovation.

Modi said the country’s blue economy initiatives were gaining momentum, helping position north Andhra Pradesh as a “coastal economic corridor”.

Generating employment through investment remained the government’s priority, he said.

The blue economy refers to the sustainable use of ocean and coastal resources to drive economic growth, create jobs, and safeguard marine ecosystems.

Projects worth Rs 2 lakh crore had been announced for Andhra Pradesh in recent years, while railway projects worth Rs 1 lakh crore were under implementation in the state.

The PM said Andhra Pradesh had the potential to become a hub for manufacturing and the pharmaceutical sector.

During his address, Modi said the country’s aviation sector had witnessed remarkable growth over the past 12 years, with the number of airports more than doubling from 74 to 166.

The naming of the airport reflected the government’s emphasis on recognising the contributions of inspiring personalities from the country’s rich history, he said.

Taking a swipe at the Congress and the Gandhi family,

Modi said, “Earlier, airports were named only after one family,” and asserted that his government had changed that practice.

He cited the naming of the airport at Varanasi after Maharsi Valmiki as an example.

Referring to the regional connectivity scheme UDAN (Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik), Modi said it had enabled people from smaller towns to travel by air.

He said the NDA government in Andhra Pradesh, led by Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu and Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan, was working at “double speed” to accelerate the state’s development.

Speaking on the occasion, Chandrababu Naidu described the Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport in Vizianagaram district as the “jewel of north Andhra”, saying it would transform the region’s economic landscape.

Modi, accompanied by Naidu and Civil Aviation Minister K Rammoohan Naidu, arrived at the venue in an open-top vehicle amid cheers from the gathering.

The Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport at Bhogapuram is the country’s second greenfield airport to commence operations this year, after Uttar Pradesh’s Jewar airport, which began commercial flight operations on June 15.

In a statement, the GMR Group said the airport had been completed several months ahead of schedule and would begin commercial operations on August 17.

Spread over 2,200 acres, the airport has been developed by GMR Visakhapatnam International Airport Ltd under the Public-Private Partnership model on a Design, Build, Finance, Operate and Transfer basis.

The integrated project spans 2,703.26 acres, comprising the airport spread across 2,203.32 acres, a 500-acre aviation hub, and an aviation university and EduCity over 136.63 acres, besides comprehensive airside infrastructure, commercial development, residential zones and approach roads.

GMR Airports Ltd, part of the GMR Group, operates six airports and has developed greenfield airports at Hyderabad, Goa and Bhogapuram.

In Mysuru, PM Modi inaugurated the Swami Vivekananda Cultural Youth Centre - Viveka Smaraka - at Sri Ramakrishna Ashrama here.

He also offered prayers and floral tributes to Sri Ramakrishna

Paramahansa, his wife ‘Maa’ Sharada Devi and disciple Swami Vivekananda.

Karnataka Governor Thawarchand Gehlot and Chief Minister D K Shivakumar accompanied him.

According to an official statement, the Viveka Smaraka commemorates Swami Vivekananda’s historic visit to Mysuru in November 1892 during his journey across India.

Abuse video

to Connaught Place with my friends in July. We came across a group of people who were using abusive and objectionable language against the Prime Minister. They influenced me and encouraged me to repeat those words, and I did.”

She added, “I am not able to look anyone in the eye. I appeal to the entire country and everyone to please forgive me. I am only 15 years old. This is my first and last mistake, and I will never repeat such an act again.”

The apology video surfaced after the girl was subjected to a police complaint.

The officer on Friday said Delhi Police will first examine the contents of the Zero FIR registered in Noida on July 29 before taking further action.

The FIR was transferred to Delhi on Friday as the alleged offence took place in the national capital.

Earlier, Delhi Police registered an FIR at the Special Cell Police Station over the circulation of the content, issued notices to social media platform X seeking its removal, and sought preservation of relevant electronic records as part of the investigation.

Golden Punch

After a bit of struggle against his taller opponent, Jadumani rallied to win the first round 3-2.

However, Dixon then showed his wares and fought back brilliantly to take the second round by an 5-0 unanimous verdict.

The Aussie used the momentum to edge out his opponent and end India’s golden run in the boxing ring.

Jadumani had stormed into the men’s 55kg final after pulling off a 5-0 unanimous decision victory against Philip Haseob of Namibia on Friday.

In the women’s section, Jais-

mine took the first round by a split verdict after a close contest with both boxers challenging each other.

However, Jaismine won the second round by a unanimous verdict, having landed some hard blows on her opponents.

Earlier, 22-year-old Preeti made a commanding start to her gold-medal bout, winning the opening round unanimously with all five judges adjudicating 10-8 in the Indian’s favour.

The World No. 3 in the bantamweight division started the second round on a positive note and continued in the same vein to emerge winner for India’s first gold medal of the day.

Para stars

the most productive one for Indian para sports with Bhavina Patel and Sonalben Patel winning a gold and a bronze respectively in para table tennis.

Sudhir, who won gold in para powerlifting in Birmingham, was later stripped of his medal after failing an in-competition dope test.

In Glasgow, para track and field athletes scooped six medals -- 3 gold, 2 silver, 1 bronze -- while Jhandu Kumar clinched the other bronze in para powerlifting.

The para athletics team also ended India’s 20-year wait for a medal at the CWG.

The last medal from para athletics before Glasgow came from Ranjith Kumar Jayaseelan in the men’s seated Discus Throw event in the 2006 edition.

There were three double podium finishes for India in para athletics in Glasgow -- Sharmila (gold) and Shilpa Shyla (bronze) in women’s shot put F57; Dilip Mahadu Gavit (gold) and Mohammed Basil (silver) in men’s 100m T47; and Soman Rana (gold) and Shubham Juyal (silver) in men’s Shot Put F57.

Indians also created one Games record and one Asian record.

During the official send-off event of the para sports team, Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) President Devendra Jhajharia had said India can win a record-breaking half a dozen medals in para sports in the Glasgow Commonwealth Games.

While the para powerlifters had their pre-CWG training camp in SAI Gandhinagar, the para-athletics team had their camp in SAI Bengaluru. MPOST

PRESENTS LOKMANYA TILAK NATIONAL AWARD TO AJIT DOVAL

Shah: NSA Doval played key role in strengthening India’s foreign policy

OUR CORRESPONDENT

PUNE: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Saturday said National Security Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval has played a great role in strengthening India’s foreign policy and has had a ‘role and advice’ in the background of every decision taken by Prime Minister Narendra Modi for national security. Addressing a programme after presenting the Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026 to NSA Doval here, Shah said India has embarked on the path of cultural nationalism envisioned by Tilak, and asserted that there would be no reversal from that course. Shah said the first selection PM Modi did after assuming office in 2014 was to appoint Ajit Doval as NSA. “NSA Ajit Doval has played a great role in strengthening India’s foreign policy. In



Union Home minister Amit Shah presents the ‘Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026’ to National Security Advisor Ajit Doval in the presence of Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis, in Pune

every decision of PM Modi for national security, Doval has had a ‘role and advice’ in the background,” Shah said. He hailed Doval’s long career in the Intelligence Bureau and said India has become strong and confident under Modi’s leadership, with Doval playing a major role in that

transformation. Shah said much of Doval’s work can never be fully revealed because of the nature of intelligence operations. “After becoming NSA in 2014, Doval helped implement many strategic ideas on the ground and played a major role in modernising India’s armed

Highlights

- » Shah said the first selection PM Modi did after assuming office in 2014 was to appoint Ajit Doval as NSA
- » Shah said much of Doval’s work can never be fully revealed because of the nature of intelligence operations

forces, strengthening technology, enhancing operational capability and improving the country’s defence preparedness,” the Union Home Minister said. He said the Modi government has fundamentally transformed both the defensive and offensive capabilities of India’s armed forces over the past 12 years, with Doval making a significant contribution. He hailed Tilak’s unparalleled contribution, saying his immortal slogan, “Swarajya is my birthright, and I shall have it,” gave a new direction to India’s freedom struggle and inspired generations of freedom fighters. Shah said the slogan made people realise that self-rule was their right and not a favour from anyone. He said Tilak’s life and teachings continue to inspire the country’s youth and remain relevant in nation-building. “Tilak united people and connected them with the freedom movement through the public Ganesh festival. India is now moving firmly on the path of cultural nationalism laid down by Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak, and no one can reverse that journey,” Shah added.

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh government has introduced a major change in the management of the Mid-Day Meal scheme in state-run schools by removing pradhans (village heads) from the operation of the programme and its financial management. An order issued by the Directorate General of School Education states that the scheme will now be jointly managed by the chairman of the School Management Committee (SMC), who is a parent of a student, and the headmaster of the school. Earlier, the Mid-Day Meal scheme and its bank account were jointly operated by the village head and the headmaster. Under the revised arrangement, the SMC chairman and the headmaster will also jointly operate the account for payment of honorarium to cooks and the contingency

The decision has drawn strong opposition from organisations representing village heads

grant provided for preparing meals under the scheme. The decision has drawn strong opposition from organisations representing village heads. Lalit Sharma, state president of the National Panchayati Raj Gram Pradhan Organisation, said elected village heads continue to function as administrators even after the expiry of the tenure of panchayats. He alleged that excluding them from the Mid-Day Meal scheme amounts to curtailing their powers. The organisation has demanded that the government withdraw the order and restore the earlier system. Meanwhile, another deci-

sion of the state government regarding postings in the Secondary Education Department has also sparked criticism. After a long wait, the department issued fresh postings for 326 Group B teachers and officers who were recently promoted. However, the appointment of Kailash Yadav as principal of the Government Girls Inter College in Dhanupur, Prayagraj, has been opposed by the Government Secondary Teachers’ Association. In a representation to Additional Chief Secretary for Basic and Secondary Education Parth Sarathi Sen Sharma, the association urged the government not to appoint male cadre officers as principals of Government Girls Inter Colleges. Provincial General Secretary Arun Yadav and Provincial Patron Rameshwar Pandey said such appointments should be avoided.

PUBLIC EXAMINATIONS (PREVENTION OF UNFAIR MEANS) ACT

A strong legal foundation for hard work of youth and transparency

To all my young friends. When a question paper is leaked, fake candidates sit for exams, cyber methods are used to disrupt the examination process, or organised gangs tamper with the entire system, the damage is not limited to a single exam — it strikes a deep blow to the trust of youth, the credibility of administrative systems, and the spirit of equal opportunity. Keeping this in mind, under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Central government implemented the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. This is the country’s first dedicated law aimed at protecting the sanctity of public examinations and ensuring strict action against any kind of fraud in the examination process.



Yojana, Startup India, Standup India, Atal Innovation Mission, Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana, Digital India, and Vidya Lakshmi have created new opportunities for youth to learn, innovate, and pursue self-employment. Today, the country’s youth are not limited to seeking employment alone, they are actively creating jobs, driving innovation, and playing an active role in building a developed India. This youth-centric approach is giving new momentum to India’s development journey and forming a strong foundation for realising the resolutions of the Amrit Kaal.

Transparent and Merit-Based Recruitment System in Haryana

Alongside the strong legal framework implemented at the national level to safeguard public examinations, Haryana too has undertaken numerous reforms to give the highest priority to transparency and merit in its recruitment processes. The state government’s clear vision is that opportunities for government service should be granted solely on the basis of talent, merit, and hard work. In line with this thinking, the extensive use of technology in recruitment processes, digital systems, time-bound selection procedures, and transparent mechanisms have been continuously strengthened. Various administrative reforms have been implemented to reduce unnecessary human intervention in the recruitment process, enhance impartiality, and ensure accountability. The objective of these efforts is not merely to make appointments, but to establish among youth the belief that their hard work will be respected and the selection process will remain fair.

Today, in the state, more than 1.80 lakh youth have been given government jobs on the principle of “Bina Kharchi-Bina Parchi”, based entirely on transparency and merit. Through the Common Eligibility Test (CET), the recruitment process has been made simple, fair, and transparent. When every candidate enters the examination hall believing that their success will be determined solely by their merit, ability, and hard work, only then will a truly equal-opportunity system be established. This trust is the hallmark of capable and transparent governance — it is the strength of a developed Haryana, and it is also the strong foundation of a developed India.

Such a fair and reliable examination system will not only protect the dreams of the youth but will also play a vital role in making India a more capable, more competitive, and more just nation in the future. — Nayab Singh Saini Haryana Chief Minister

The Broad Scope of the Law

This Act applies to public examinations through which selections are made for various central government services, institutions, and admission to higher education. These include the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC), the Staff Selection Commission (SSC), the National Testing Agency (NTA), the Railway Recruitment Boards (RRBs), the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection (IBPS), and other examination bodies notified by the Central government. The most important feature of this law is that, for the first time, examination offences have been clearly defined. Leaking a question paper, providing question papers or answer keys, seating a fake candidate for an exam, tampering with computer networks or digital systems, enabling cheating through electronic devices, misusing confidential information, and influencing the examination process for financial gain are all now explicitly punishable offences.

The 2026 Amendments: Toward Comprehensive Control Over Examination Offences The real strength of any effective law lies not merely in its creation, but in its ability to strengthen itself in step with changing circumstances over time. After the Act came into force in 2024, it became evident that examination offences were becoming increasingly technology-driven, organised, and inter-state in nature. Gangs leaking question papers had begun using digital platforms, encrypted communication channels, cyber networks, and modern methods of financial transactions. It thus became necessary for the law to be strengthened to meet these new challenges. With this purpose, significant amendments were made to the Act in 2026. The core objective of these amendments was not merely to increase penalties, but to make the investigation, prosecution, and judicial process more

effective, so that timely and decisive action could be ensured against organised examination crimes. Under the amended provisions, states and union territories were granted the authority to constitute Special Task Forces (Special Investigation Teams) as needed. This paved the way for coordinated action against organised networks that operate across multiple states to disrupt the examination process. Given the changing nature of examination crimes, this provision was considered extremely important, since most cases are no longer confined to a single state. The amendments placed special emphasis on the scientific analysis of digital and electronic evidence. Efforts were made to further strengthen the capabilities of investigating agencies through the effective use of cyber forensics, data analysis, electronic records, and evidence linked to digital communication. At the same time, the system for rapid exchange of information between various states and central agencies was also reinforced, enabling quicker action against offenders. Important steps were also taken to expedite the judicial process. Emphasis was placed on special arrangements for the swift resolution of cases related to examination offences, so that cases would no longer remain pending for years and offenders could be punished through a time-bound judicial process. Speedy justice not only enhances the effectiveness of the law but also sends the message to society that any tampering with the examination system will be treated as a serious crime. Youth Empowerment: The Foundation of Viksit Bharat Over the past twelve years under the leadership of PM Modi, the youth have come to be regarded not merely as job-seekers, but as the greatest partners in India’s development. With this vision, numerous policy decisions have been made centered on education, skill development, innovation, entrepreneurship, and self-reliance. The New Education Policy 2020 paved the way for making education more practical and aligned with future needs, while initiatives such as the Skill India Mission, Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Home minister Amit Shah has approved the release of an amount of Rs 2,117.85 crore from the Central share of the State Disaster Response Fund (SDRF) to seven flood-hit states that were affected during the current southwest monsoon of 2026.

The assistance has been approved to Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha and Nagaland for relief, rescue and rehabilitation measures.

The Union Home Ministry said that it has been closely monitoring the situation in the states in consonance with the action taken by the state government and is providing the necessary support for managing the situation arising out of



Odisha Disaster Rapid Action Force (ODRAF) conduct a rescue operation in the flood-affected areas at Banki, in Cuttack, Saturday

the disaster.

The Ministry of Home Affairs has been closely monitoring the situation since the commencement of the monsoon along with state governments and was also providing the necessary logistics and sup-

port, including deployment of National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) personnel. The Union ministry has also been providing assistance from the Central share of SDRF on a priority basis to the seven states which have been affected.

Besides, Inter-Ministerial Central Teams (IMCT) have visited Arunachal Pradesh and Assam to assess the damage besides conducting two assessments in Assam as the situation there was grave. Similarly, an IMCT will be sent to Nagaland as per the request received from the state government. Under the approval of Rs 2,117.85 crore, Arunachal Pradesh has been given Rs 44.55 crore, Assam- Rs 379.35 crore, Gujarat- Rs 500 crore and Maharashtra- Rs 500 crore as the first instalment of the share of SDRF.

On the other hand, Himachal Pradesh and Odisha which had already received the first instalment of the State Disaster Response Fund for the current fiscal, have been given Rs 193.95 crore and Rs 500 crore respectively as an advance for the second instalment.

FIR registered against Anil Ambani, Reliance Capital in EPFO fraud case

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) registered a First Information Report (FIR) against Reliance Capital Limited (RCL), former Chairman Anil D Ambani,

unknown public servants and other persons in relation to alleged diversion of Rs 1,816.22 crore belonging to Employees’ Provident Fund Organisation. The FIR was registered on Friday, on a complaint by the EPFO ministry. It was alleged

that the respondents had caused a wrong gain/wrong loss of Rs 1,007.55 crore plus interest of Rs 808.67 crore by committing offences of criminal conspiracy, cheating, criminal breach of trust, and criminal misconduct. According to the FIR, dur-

ing the financial year 2013 and 2014, RCL issued secured Non-convertible Debentures (NCDs), in which EPFO had invested Rs 2,500 crore through four portfolio managers including Reliance Capital Asset Management Limited.

Kejriwal to march to PM’s residence on August 4 on E20 petrol issue

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Stepping up his campaign against the use of E20 petrol, AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal on Saturday announced that he would march to the Prime Minister’s residence on August 4 to submit a petition containing two lakh signatures collected through an online campaign.

Addressing a “National Town Hall Against E20” at the Constitution Club of India here, Kejriwal said he would start the march at 12 noon on Tuesday with 100 volunteers.

The Aam Aadmi Party national convenor appealed to those willing to accompany him to inform him through social media and said he expected to be allowed to proceed up to the same point where the Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, was recently “permitted” during a march to the Prime Minister’s residence.

GAIL (India) Limited
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)

LNG Shipping

LNG TERMINAL

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LIQUID HYDROCARBONS

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CITY GAS DISTRIBUTION

RENEWABLES

COMPRESSED BIO-GAS

GREEN HYDROGEN

STRENGTH BEHIND INDIA'S ENERGY SECURITY

UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30th JUNE, 2026

Pursuant to Regulation 52(4) SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015

HIGHLIGHTS (Q1 FY 2026-27)

Revenue from Operations (Standalone)
₹38,982 crore

PBT (Standalone)
₹5,773 crore

NG Transmission
122.36 MMSCMD

ENERGISING TODAY. SECURING TOMORROW

Date: 31.07.2026
Place: New Delhi

The results can be accessed through the following link:
https://www.gailonline.com/Financial_Results.html or scan:

Regd. Off: 16, Bhikaiji Cama Place, R. K. Puram, New Delhi-110 066 | www.gailonline.com | CIN: L40200DL1984GOI018976

By order of the Board
GAIL (India) Limited
Sd/-
S. K. Sinha
Director (Finance) & CFO
DIN: 10528036

Follow us on:

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**
E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 26/35 Dt. 31.07.2026

E-Procurement Tender Notice
On behalf of the President of India, **The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj**, (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit) invites the following E-Procurement Tenders.

S. No.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	38261612	NON-ASBESTOS 'L' TYPE COMPOSITION BRAKE BLOCK	82547 Nos.	27.08.2026
2	38261512	SPRING PLANK FOR CASNUB 22W BOGIE	1275 Nos.	31.08.2026
3	38261886	LOAD SENSING VALVE	3647 Nos.	02.09.2026
4	38263123	CAST STEEL WEDGE	3927 NOS.	24.09.2026
5	30262046	SECONDARY SPRING FOR CHAIR CAR (INNER) FOR FIAT BOGIE OF LHB COACHES	286 NOS.	24.08.2026
6	30263103	DOUBLE SIDE OPENABLE DOOR CLOSER CONCEALED TYPE	1082 NOS.	08.09.2026
7	38262516	BUSH (BRONZE) FOR DOOR OPERATING MECHANISM	2018 Nos.	17.08.2026
8	38264264	ROUND HEAD LOCK BOLT 19.05 MM DIA	135355 Nos.	29.09.2026
9	38261443	FLAP DOOR ARRANGEMENT	1604 Nos.	12.10.2026

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from IREPS website i.e. <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper. **1763/26(AK)**

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender Notice
Dy CE (TMC) Line JHS acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites open tender through E-Tenders with closing date mentioned against each:

E-Tender Notice No. : JHS-TMC-07-2026 | Estimated value (Rs.) : 18462207.69

Name of work : Repair and overhauling of Hydraulic pump and motors used on Track machines.

Earnest money (Rs.) : 369300.00 | Tender closing date & time : 24.08.2026

Period of completion : 24 months

Tender can be submitted online on date mentioned against each up to **15:00 Hrs.** For details description & submission of tender, please see website of Indian Railway www.ireps.gov.in. Detail of Tender notice can also be seen on Notice Board of Dy. CE (TMC) Line office Jhansi. **1765/26 (C)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender No. - PRYJ-Sig-024-2026-27

E-TENDER NOTICE
Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Coordination / North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **12.00 hrs.** on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. **The details of the Tender are as under:-**

Name of Work : Comprehensive AMC of SMPS based IPS systems (STATCON make) installed at stations and Relay Huts/Gates in SrOSTE/Co/PRYJ's Section of PRYJ Division for a period of Three years.

Tender No. : 025 | Approx. Cost of work : 17102530.92

Earnest Money : 342100/- | Cost of Tender Form : 0.00

Completion period : 36 Months | Date of Opening of tender : 27.08.2026

Availability of tender form : Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in.

Earnest Money to be deposited : The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

Time & place of opening of tender : Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

Validity of offer : 60 days from the date of opening.

Right of Railway to deal with tender : Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **1764/26 (AS)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender No. : PRYJ-Sig-024-2026-27

E-TENDER NOTICE
Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **12.00 hrs.** on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. **The details of the Tender are as under:-**

Name of Work : Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for Siemens make MSDAC, installed at SJT, PCOI and NYN-MKP section of PRYJ division for a period of Three years.

Earnest Money : ₹ 662600/- | Cost of Tender form: ₹ 0.00

Completion Period : 36 Months | Date of Opening of Tender : 27.08.2026

Availability of tender form : Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in. Earnest Money to be deposited: The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. **Time, Date & Place of opening of Tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **Right of Railway to deal with Tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **1753/26 (A)**

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

T. Notice No. : GSU/Elect/PRYJ-E-Tender Notice/2026/70 | Date: 31.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/GSU/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tender are as under:-

Tender No. : GSU-EL-WC-75-2026

Description of work: "Electrical work in connection with "Provision of 12 m wide FOB at GMC yard regarding developed GMC yard as satellite station in Prayagraj division"

Advertised Value: Rs. 6356720.24 | Bid Security: Rs. 127200.00

Completion Period: 08 Months | Bidding system: Single Packet

Tender Closing date & Time: 24.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

Tender opening date & Time: 24.08.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Note: - 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **1759/26 (PH)**

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

T. Notice No. : GSU/Elect/PRYJ-E-Tender Notice/2026/70 | Date: 31.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/GSU/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tender are as under:-

Tender No. : GSU-EL-WC-75-2026

Description of work: "Electrical work in connection with "Provision of 12 m wide FOB at GMC yard regarding developed GMC yard as satellite station in Prayagraj division"

Advertised Value: Rs. 6356720.24 | Bid Security: Rs. 127200.00

Completion Period: 08 Months | Bidding system: Single Packet

Tender Closing date & Time: 24.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

Tender opening date & Time: 24.08.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Note: - 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. **1757/26 (C)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	19260632	ELASTIC RING ACLATHAN RING FOR WAG-9, WAP-7 AND WAP-5 ELECTRIC LOCOMOTIVES	381 NOS	28.08.2026
02	19260629	SUSPENSION TUBE COMPLETE FOR WAP-7/WAG-9	97 NOS	28.08.2026
03	19261697	PANTO FOOT INSULATOR	390 NOS	28.08.2026
04	19261766	METALIZED CARBON STRIP	2009 NOS	28.08.2026
05	19264439	DOUBLE ROW SELF ALIGNING SPHERICAL ROLLER BEARING	247 NOS	29.08.2026

Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No.: 31/2026-2027 | Dated: 31.07.2026 | 2662/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of Accused Person

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Vivek Aggarwal, S/o:** Umesh Aggarwal R/o: C-90, Mahendru Enclave, Gali No. 4, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 6700/17, U/S: 138 NI Act, PS: Hauz Qazi, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Vivek Aggarwal**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Vivek Aggarwal**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Vivek Aggarwal**, of **CC No. 6700/17, U/S: 138 NI Act, PS: Hauz Qazi, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.09.2026**.

By Order
Arvind Tomar
LD. Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act)-07,
Central Court No. 507, Extension Block
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/10479/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

**SOUTHERN RAILWAY**

CARRIAGE & WAGON WORKS

Tender Notice No. : LHBFIATBOGIE-0726.

For and on behalf of President of India, Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage and Wagon Works, Southern Railway, Ayayavaram, Chennai-600 023 invites e-tender for the following work as per the tender notice given in e-tender portal www.ireps.gov.in

Name of work :- Stripping, Cleaning and Epoxy Painting of LHB Fiat Bogies and Associated Components.

Approximate cash value (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Bidding start date	Tender closing date and time	Cost of tender form (Rs.)	Period of Completion in Months
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
1,14,54,496.00	2,29,100.00	06.08.2026	20.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs.	Nil	12 Months

Website Address: www.ireps.gov.in

Office Address: Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage & Wagon Works, Southern Railway, Ayayavaram, Chennai-600 023.

Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage & Wagon Works

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of Accused Person

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Jyoti Awasthi**, Authorised Signatory of M/s Avinash EM Project Pvt. Ltd. B-14 DLF Gurugram, Haryana has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 724/2020, U/s: 138 NI Act, PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jyoti Awasthi**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jyoti Awasthi**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Jyoti Awasthi**, of **CC No. 724/2020, U/s: 138 NI Act, PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026**.

By Order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North)
Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10623/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, Near Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Kapil Mehta/ Nitu Mehta/ LBNOD00004734005 / LBNOD00004734006	Flat No 2/8, PF-4/0004, Ground Floor, Primrose Situated At Vatika City, Sector -49,village Badshapur And Ghasola, Tehsil And Dist Gurgaon Sohna Road, Haryana, July 29, 2026	April 28, 2026 Rs. 45,89,034.34/-	Gurgaon (Haryana)

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: August 02, 2026
Place: Gurgaon (Haryana)

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**UJVN Limited**

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvn.com

Tender Notice
दिनांक: 01/08/2026

पत्र सं. 642

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), UJVN Ltd., Kalagarh, Pauri Garhwal, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders are given below:
Tender No. : 05/EE(Civil)/Kalagarh/Pauri Garhwal/2026-27
Name of Work: "Annual Horticulture Maintenance & Development of Parks and Play Ground at Hydol Colony Kalagarh".
Estimated Cost: Rs. 15,91,527.87 (GST extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: From 17:00 hrs of 03.08.2026
Last Date for submission of tender : Up to 15:00 hrs of 25.08.2026
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website, the tender document can be downloaded from the Nigam's website www.ujvn.com
Executive Engineer (Civil),
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of Accused Person

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Jabaz, S/o:** Sada, R/o: N-15/B-45, Gali No. 1 Sapera Basti, Indira Vikas Colony, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 226/22, CR Case No: 4195/2022, PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jabaz**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jabaz**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Jabaz**, of **FIR No. 226/22, CR Case No: 4195/2022, PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.09.2026**.

By Order
Amardeep Kaur
Ld. Additional Chif Judicial Magistrate North
Room No. 117
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10265/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of Accused Person

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Amin S/o** Adish Khan R/o Yaseen Kabab Corner Basti Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi **Parmanent Add.** Village Sathni Distt. Aligarh U.P. has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 255/2024 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amin** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amin** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Amin** accused of **FIR No. 255/2024 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
JMFC-03, Room No. 512
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/10686/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

**EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender Notice
e-Tender Notice No. 01 of 2026-27 (Open) - Gati Shakti Unit/DDU

Online (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by CAO/Con/RSP/ MHX for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings. **Tender No. 01-DYCPM-GSU-DDU-26-27. (I) Name of the work and its location :** Additional works for the upgradation and improvement of passenger amenities at ABSS stations under DDU Division, East Central Railway, including the provision of canopies, pathways, approach roads, boundary walls, sheds, UTS/PRS buildings, facade improvement of station buildings, cable ducts, entry and exit gates, rainwater harvesting systems, improvement of circulating areas and station buildings, and other miscellaneous works within the station premises at CMDR, DGO, BBU, KTO, SSM, DOS, AUBR, RFJ, GURRU, KBX, PIRO, NBB, JPL, HDN and MDM stations. (ii) **Advertised Value :** ₹ 67,93,58,606.56, (iii) **Earnest Money :** ₹ 1,35,87,200.00. (iv) **Closing Date & Time for submission of e-tender :** 07.09.2026, UP-to 15:00 hrs. (v) **Website particulars of e-tendering:** www.ireps.gov.in

Chief Administrative Officer/Con/RSP,
Construction Department, ECR, MHX/PIBNE
PR/0644/DGU/SGT/26-27/44

**EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender Notice
ECR-CAO-C-S-ETEN-DOS-07

E-tender is invited on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work:- **SN. 1, e-Tender No. ECR-CAO-C-S-ETEN-DOS-07 in two packet system, Name of Work :** Earthwork, Blanketing, P way work, Minor bridge work, Retaining wall, Drain, Platform, Approach Road, Circulating Area, OFC Rooms and other ancillary civil engineering works under proposed alignment in connection with Sone Nagar Bye pass line from Chairaila Pauthi (Ch. 10196) of GC line to New Sone Nagar (Ch. 1088) on BD line under DDU Division of E C Railway. **Approx Cost of the Work (in Rs.) :** 50,57,65,987.91. **Bid Security :** 1,01,15,300.00. **Period of Work Completion:** 12 (Twelve) Months. **Date and time for closing of tender:** 19.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. Any e-tender which is sent by Post/Courier/ Fax or by hand will not be accepted. All such manual submission of tender, even if it is on firm's letter pad or received in time, will not be accepted. The above e-tender document along with full information is available on website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. **Note:** In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> at least 15 days before last date of closing, for latest corrigendum/corrections etc in connection with this tender.

Dy. Chief Engineer/Con,
East Central Railway, Dehri on Sone.
PR/0643/CONSTRUCTION DOS/CONST/1/26-27/40

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of a Person Accused

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)/ (84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Salim S/o Kamruddin R/o Vegabond Vijay Vihar, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.80001189/2025 U/s 305/331 (4)317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at PS: Budh Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Salim** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Salim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Salim** of **FIR No. 80001189/2025 U/s 305/331 (4)317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 of PS: Budh Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.09.2026**.

By order
Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 112,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10682/RD/2026

**EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY**

OPEN TENDER

Batch No - 24/2026 Dt. 29/07/2026

E-Tender Notice for supply of materials "Participation in through" Web Portal of www.ireps.gov.in. Offers are invited for supply of the following material. The closing time for the tender is at 14.00 Hrs. **SL. No. 01. Tender No. :** 39265292A, **Short Description of item :** Supply, installation and commissioning of Exothermic cutting equipment (Full set) as per attached technical specification. Make: Broco India or similar. Quantity: 4 Set. **Publishing Date & Time :** 31-AUG-26, 14:00 Hrs. Participants are required to submit their offer only on-line through the web Portal of www.ireps.gov.in before the closing date and time. Other details regarding Consignee and detailed description of stores are available in tender document in tender notice on the above portal.

Sr DMM/ECR/DHN
PR/0641/DHN/STORE/17/26-27/28

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender Notice
T. Notice No.: 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJE-Tender Notice/2026/648 | Date: 31.07.2026

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/ N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T. No.: 230-TRD- WC-1037-2026

Description of work : 25 KV OHE modification in NTPC siding Dadri due to signal infringement and critical OHE reliability enhancement works in siding over Prayagraj Division.

Advertised value: Rs. 3,60,71,393.20 | Bid Security: Rs. 7,21,400.00

Completion Period: 12 Months | Bidding system: Single Packet

Tender Closing date & Time: 21.08.2026 & 14:00 Hrs

Tender opening date & Time: 21.08.2026 & 15:00 Hrs

Note: (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. (3) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **1766/26 (D)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of Accused Person

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Balbir Singh S/o** Vikram Singh R/o OLD No. 1002, New No. 896 Sector 9, Old Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad City UP -201009 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 1911/24, U/s 138 NI Act PS: Rajinder Nagar Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Balbir Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Balbir Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Balbir Singh** accused of **CC No. 1911/24, U/s 138 NI Act PS: Rajinder Nagar Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Arjun Kirar
Ld. JMFC-05 NI Act, Central
CBA-1, Room No. 02
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10558/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of Accused Person

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Pawan Kumar, S/o:** Pappu @Om parkash, R/o: H.No. E-294, Jahangir Puri, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 211/2016, U/s: 457/380/411 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Jahangir Puri, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Pawan Kumar**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Pawan Kumar**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Pawan Kumar, FIR No. 211/2016, U/s: 457/380/411 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Jahangir Puri, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Room No. 0

Fists full of gold

Preeti, Jaismine, Sachin lead India's boxing gold rush; Lovlina settles for silver

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GLASGOW: India capped a memorable campaign in the Commonwealth Games boxing competition with seven gold medals, though Olympics medallist Lovlina Borgohain had to settle for silver after going down to Australia's Emma-Sue Greentree in the women's 70kg final on Sunday.

Lovlina lost 1-4 in a split verdict as India finished the competition with an impressive haul, led by gold medallists Preeti Pawar, Jaismine Lamboria, Sakshi Chaudhary, Arundhati Choudhary and Priya Ghanghas. Jadumani Singh added a silver after finishing runner-up in the men's final.

The day belonged to India's women, who dominated the ring with a series of commanding performances.

Preeti Pawar opened the gold rush with a clinical 5-0 victory over Canada's Scarlett Delgado in the women's 54kg final. Moments later, reigning world champion Jaismine Lamboria outboxed defending champion Michaela Walsh of Northern Ireland by an identical margin in the 57kg title bout.

Sakshi Chaudhary continued the winning run, overwhelming England's Ruby



Preeti Pawar lands a blow on Canada's Scarlett Delgado; RIGHT: Sachin Siwach won a dramatic encounter



PTI

White 5-0 in the women's 51kg final, before Arundhati Choudhary produced another flawless display to defeat England's Chantelle Reid by a unanimous verdict in the women's 70kg final.

Priya Ghanghas completed India's golden day, edging Canada's Marie-Bathoul Al-Ahmadieh 4-1 in a closely fought women's 60kg final.

Both Preeti and Jaismine, who serve in the Indian Army, credited the support they have received from the Army and

Lovlina Borgohain, however, settled for a silver after losing to Emma-Sue Greentree of Australia

the Sports Authority of India.

"I am very happy to win a gold medal for India. I came here with a job to do and I'm glad I could make my country

proud," said Preeti.

She also acknowledged the role of SAI and the Army in her development. "SAI and the Army have supported me immensely. I also thank all the sports lovers in India who continue to back us," she said.

Jaismine hailed India's historic showing. "The coaches gave us excellent strategies and we executed them well. Having 10 Indian boxers in the finals at a competition of this level is historic and feels really special," she said.

On the men's side, Sachin Siwach won India's sixth boxing gold, beating Tryagain Morning Ndevelo of Namibia in a dramatic men's 60kg final.

Sachin made a remarkable comeback after he was behind his opponent in the first two rounds. In the third and final round, Sachin forced a standing count against Ndevelo, resulting in a 3-2 split verdict win. Ankush Panghal then won the country's seventh gold, beating Dimeji Shittu of England in the 80 kg final.

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: Stories of pain, overcoming odds, fighting hard, all this is routine in modern sports. Yet, there is that odd case which crops up, forcing you to believe in miracles.

If Tejaswin Shankar has achieved the unthinkable, winning a bronze medal in the nerve-wracking decathlon event at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, on Friday night, there are many men who deserve to be credited.

First, the athlete himself, who never lost faith. When he had limped off the jumps pit-five days back, it appeared his campaign was over. No, it was the beginning. Motivated by his fellow athletes, notably Murali Shreshankar, who won silver in long jump and others, Tejaswin needed time to get over the negativity.

At the other end, there was a team of medical experts working to get Tejaswin ready, in every sense. As has become the famous case with several athletes in Indian sports, Dr Dinshaw Pardiwala, noted ortho surgeon, assisted by Sumansh Sivalanka, a top sports physio, plus Wayne Lombard, the strength and conditioning coach, all were working on Tejaswin.



Tejaswin Shankar collected a total of 7976 points

PTI

Big challenge: how to get him ready, knee taped up. An injury to an athlete is different from an injury to a common man. An athlete is an Alpha Male, an athlete is superior, fitter, has more resilience. That inner strength was on view, as Tejaswin went about two days of competitions at the Scotstoun arena in Glasgow, where the weather was unkind. First, showers, then the chill and strong breeze. All this can make an injury more painful. Dr Pardiwala and I are staying in the same hotel in Glasgow, so the updates were regular. I had said, I would not write anything till the event was over.

As Tejaswin won the bronze medal, I recalled my conversa-

tions with Dr Pardiwala and Sumansh. Behind the scenes, so much work on an athlete that he pushes his body - beyond limits. The joy and glow was there to see on Tejaswin's face. This is history -- India winning a decathlon medal at the Commonwealth Games. This is the biggest medal of the Games, if you can understand the nuances. This is the biggest story of competing in pain and against several barriers. What this has shown, Indian athletes are fearless, fierce. Let's not talk of points won, it was slightly less than 8,000 aggregate. Yet, to make up in the second day and bounce back into medal reckoning, Tejaswin has won millions of hearts.

THE SWEET SCENT OF SUCCESS

Jaismine won the bout of illness before CWG gold



Jaismine Lamboria beat Northern Ireland's Michaela Walsh in the 57kg final

GLASGOW: Weeks before stepping into the ring at the Commonwealth Games, reigning 57kg world champion Jaismine Lamboria was confined to a hospital bed, battling a relentless illness that threatened to derail her participation in Glasgow.

On Saturday, the 24-year-old from Bhiwani completed a remarkable turnaround, defeating defending champion Michaela Walsh of Northern Ireland to clinch the women's 57kg gold medal and improved upon her bronze winning show in Birmingham four years back.

For those watching from the stands, Jaismine looked every bit the overwhelming favourite. But behind the scenes, the past few months had been a battle away from the boxing ring.

Her troubles began at the Asian Championships in March, where she fought despite running a high fever. Refusing to withdraw, she battled through three gruelling bouts to reach the final, earning a silver medal and securing direct qualification for the Commonwealth Games.

"I was running high fever after my very first bout," Jaismine recalled. "I was in bad shape. Somehow I reached the semifinal and there I fought a very tough contest and won 3-2. Those three fights were extremely difficult, but I gave

The past few months had been a battle away from the boxing ring

everything I had," she told PTI.

The tournament extracted a heavy toll. In the final, she suffered a blow to the head that resulted in a concussion, forcing doctors to conduct scans. Fortunately, the reports came back clear.

Just when she thought the worst was behind her, illness struck again. "I returned to India, trained for around 20 days and then again fell sick. I had high fever, was on a lot of medication and was even admitted to hospital," she said.

"I don't know what this illness is. I hope everything is alright and I recover," she had said. The setback forced her to miss India's exposure camp in the Czech Republic in June, severely disrupting preparations for what was the biggest competition of her year as the 57kg category is absent from the Asian Games.

The prolonged layoff inevitably took a mental toll. "I did have a lot of negative thoughts," she admitted. Working with a sports psychologist proved crucial in helping her regain confidence.

Silver lining for Neeraj; bronze for Yashvir

GLASGOW: Indian javelin throw superstar Neeraj Chopra was not at his best under testing conditions but still delivered a silver medal while Yashvir Singh fetched a surprise bronze with his last throw in the Commonwealth Games here on Friday.

The 28-year-old Tokyo Olympics champion produced a season's best throw of 85.83m in his second attempt, which was good enough for a second place finish. His effort on Friday was just a shade better than the 85.69m he had come up while finishing fourth at the Doha Diamond League on June 19, his only other event this season.

The 24-year-old Yashvir on his debut at Games stunned one and all with a personal best 85.41m throw in his sixth and final attempt as Indians finish 2-3 on the podium. His earlier personal best was 83.72m. He was at seventh spot after the penultimate round with his third attempt measuring 81.33m before producing a memorable 85.41m throw to join Chopra on the podium.

Sri Lankan star Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage won the gold as expected with a best throw of 89.75m which he recorded in his second attempt.

The near-90m throw was noteworthy as the athletes were competing under cold and



Neeraj Chopra produced a season's best throw of 85.83m to win silver

PTI

"I can't say fitness is like before. But I'm getting there slowly. There is still time for the Asian Games. I will compete in Diamond League before that"

— Neeraj Chopra

windy conditions. He is the lone javelin thrower this season to have breached the 90m mark. He has a personal and season best throw of 92.62m which he had recorded while winning the Rome Diamond

League title in June.

Chopra had returned from a lower back injury that has troubled him since September last year. The injury delayed his return until the Diamond League in Doha. It was his second Commonwealth Games, having won a gold in the 2018 edition in Gold Coast.

He indicated that he was still not at his full fitness but slowly getting there. "I can't say fitness is like before. But I'm getting there slowly. There is still time for the Asian Games. I will compete in Diamond League before that. There will be more improvement. Will improve slowly," Chopra said.

For Yashvir, sharing the podium with Chopra was a happy moment for him. "I am happy that I could do my personal best and also get a medal in such conditions," he said.

Tanvi enters Taipei final, Unnati out

TAIPEI CITY: Young Indian shuttler Tanvi Sharma stayed on course for her maiden BWF World Tour title, producing another commanding display to outclass Chinese Taipei's Huang Yu-Hsun in straight games and enter the women's singles final of the Taipei Open Super 300 here on Saturday.

The 17-year-old from Punjab, who finished runner-up at last year's US Open Super 300, outclassed World No. 24 Yu-Hsun 21-17 21-11 in a one-sided semifinal that lasted just 33 minutes. It could have been a dream final between two Indians but Unnati Hooda suffered a 15-21 18-21 loss to world No. 21 Thuy

Linh Nguyen of Vietnam in the other women's singles semifinal.

Tanvi, the Junior World Championships silver medallist, will take on the Vietnamese sixth seed in Sunday's title clash.

Tanvi, who was part of India's gold medal-winning squad at the 2024 Badminton Asia Team Championships, has enjoyed a rapid rise over the last two years. Besides finishing runner-up at the Odisha Masters Super 100 and Guwahati Masters Super 100 in 2025, she has won the Bonn International in 2024 and the Denmark Challenge in 2025.

AGENCIES

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Mohammad Saeer
Additional Civil Judge
(Senior Division), Rohtak
Harish son of Lt. Jai Bhagwan
Vs.
General Public
CNR No. HRRH02-001272-2026
Next Date 22-09-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
:-
India
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **22-09-2026 at 10:00 am.**
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/7trs=districtnotice&district=Rohtak>
Sd/- Sh. Mohammad Saeer
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
dated 30.07.2026 Rohtak

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Deepak S/o Late Shri Om Prakash R/o Jhuggi No. 132, Outram Lane, M. Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 124/2026 U/S 115(2)/126(2)/189(3/5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Deepak** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Deepak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Deepak of FIR No. 124/2026 U/S 115(2)/126(2)/189(3/5) The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **02.09.2026 at 10:00 am.**
By Order,
Ms. Amandeep Kaur
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North District, Room No. 117
Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/10632/NW/2026(Court Matter)

COUNCIL OF ARCHITECTURE

(An Autonomous Statutory Authority of Government of India, constituted under the Architects Act, 1972)

Ref. No. CA/15/AE/PN-2026/001 August 02, 2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

BEWARE OF QUACKS – FALSELY POSING AS "ARCHITECT"

Attention: General Public, Government Departments, Municipal Corporations, Development Authorities, Educational Institutions, Builders, Developers, Consultants, and all concerned.

The Council of Architecture hereby informs all stakeholders that only persons possessing recognised qualifications and registered as an Architect with the Council under the provisions of the Architects Act, 1972 are legally entitled to use the title and style of "Architect" throughout the territory of India. The Architects registered with the Council do not require any further registration with any Local Body/ Authority to practice the profession of Architecture.

Any person (individual/ legal entity) soliciting Architectural Work/ Services by falsely posing/ misrepresenting as an "Architect" or using the title and style of "Architect", shall be liable to be punished in terms of Sections 36 and 37 of the Architects Act, 1972 and relevant provisions of Bhartiya Nyay Sanhita 2023.

The Council calls upon all the unregistered persons to immediately cease and desist from falsely posing/ misrepresenting as Architects and/or from using the title and style of "Architect" for soliciting Architectural work/ services from General Public/ Government Authorities, Developers, etc. in contravention of Sections 36 and 37 of the Architects Act, 1972. Any person found violating the provisions of the Architects Act, 1972 shall be prosecuted before the Competent Court in accordance with law.

Accordingly, General Public and all Stakeholders are advised to:

- Verify the registration status of an Architect through the Council's website at www.coa.gov.in before engaging his or her professional services.
- Report any instance of unauthorised use or misuse of the title and style of "Architect" at website of the Council on the tab "Complaints on Misuse of Title "Architect".

The identity of the complainant shall be kept confidential, subject to applicable law(s).
Issued in Public Interest. Registrar

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
Open e-tender notice no. TRD/OT/ 13/ Feeder160/26-27
E-tenders are invited from reputed contractors having proven experience, electrical license and sound financial standing supported by the valid documents for the work as per details given below:-
1. Name of work with location : Provision of separate feeder wire for Rev. line for 160 kmph work between SEB to DDU in DDU Division. 2.Approx. Cost of the work : ₹43,35,30,999.40. 3. Earnest Money/ Bid Security to be deposited : ₹86,70,600/- 4. Last date and time for submission of tender : Upto 21/08/2026 on 15.00 hrs. 5.Website particulars from where the details of e-tender can be obtained : www.reps.gov.in
Sr. Divnl. Elect. Engineer(TRD)/ ECR/Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya PR/0658/DDU/TRD/IT/26-27/28

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur(C.G.) – 492006
CIN : U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN : AABCM6288N, GST Regn No22AABCM6288NSZY, Phone : 0771-6621000 Fax : 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cg@gov.nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

CSIDC/L.A. CHHATI /RFP/04/2026 **Raipur, Dated 31/07/2026**

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation (CSIDC) a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, 1956 engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State envisages to develop "Industrial Area" at Chhati, Dhamtari, Chhattisgarh.

"Request for Proposal" (RFP) is for planning designing, financing, construction, development, marketing, operation & maintenance of proposed **DEVELOPMENT OF INDUSTRIAL AREA UNDER PUBLIC PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP (PPP) MODE IN DBFOT MODEL AT CHHATI, DHAMTARI, CHHATTISGARH** on leasehold as is where is basis.

Land	Area of land (in Acre/SQM)	Proposed Project
Chhati, Dhamtari	40 Acres (approx.) (Leasehold on as is where is basis)	Development of Industrial Area

The RFP document containing detailed terms & condition, scope of work and other details is available for download from the web portal ([website](https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in)) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> and shall be submitted online only Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenders for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk, Operated by Mjunction Services Limited, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in.

Tender may contact to Chief Engineer, CSIDC (Mob. No. +91 99264-80284) Udyog Bhawan in working hours on working days to clear their doubts if any before online submission of the tender. samvad 48626/5
Chief Engineer



Ethanol Imbroglia

FROM ENERGY SECURITY TO ENGINE SAFETY, OUR ETHANOL JOURNEY HAS BECOME A TALE OF AMBITION, CONFUSION AND THE ORDINARY MOTORIST GETTING CAUGHT IN THE MIDDLE

MORE THAN JUST PETROL



For most motorists, E20 is simply another fuel at the pump. But for policymakers, it represents something bigger. Every liter of ethanol blended into petrol reduces India's dependence on imported crude oil, keeps more foreign exchange within the country and creates a new market for Indian farmers. The program also supports India's climate commitments by lowering the carbon intensity of transport fuels.

Yet, the transition is not without questions. Can enough ethanol be produced sustainably? Will greater use of sugarcane increase pressure on water resources? Should more grain be diverted towards fuel? How quickly can automobile manufacturers adapt existing vehicles? Most important, can consumers be carried along with confidence, rather than confusion or force?

The answers will determine whether E20 becomes a success story or merely another ambitious policy that struggled in implementation. India's ethanol journey is not just about changing petrol. It is about balancing energy security, environmental goals, agricultural economics and consumer interests; all at the same time. In the end, public confidence may prove as important as ethanol itself.

MPOST BUREAU

There was a time when the Indian motorist worried about only three things before setting out on a journey – whether there was enough fuel in the tank, enough air in the tyres and enough cash in the wallet. Today, another question joins that list. “What is in my petrol tank?” Not octane ratings. Not fuel efficiency. Not the price at the pump. The conversation has shifted to ethanol percentages, E10, E20 and whispers of even higher blends in the years to come. Overnight, motorists find themselves discussing concepts that once belonged exclusively to engineers, policymakers and refinery experts.

Welcome to India's ethanol journey, a road trip where the destination appears clear enough but the milestones along the way seem to keep changing.

A Noble Mission

For years, ethanol blending was projected as one of India's most sensible energy reforms. The logic was difficult to dispute. Blend domestically produced ethanol with petrol, reduce dependence on imported crude oil, support sugarcane farmers, lower emissions and strengthen energy security. It sounded like one of those rare public policies where almost everyone stood to gain. Successive governments pushed ahead with determination. Oil companies upgraded infrastructure, auto firms prepared newer models for higher ethanol blends and ambitious targets were advanced ahead of schedule. By official measures, it became one of India's quieter policy success stories.

Then came the ordinary car-owner. Somewhere between government notifications, manufacturers' advisories, fuel pumps and service centres, confusion began replacing confidence. Owners of older vehicles started asking uncomfortable questions. Was their engine compatible with E20? Would prolonged use affect performance? Should seals, fuel lines and other components have been designed differently? If problems arose, who would accept responsibility? Would it be the vehicle manufacturer, the fuel supplier or the policymaker who encouraged the transition?

The answers were seldom as straightforward as the questions. If there were any answers at all.

Voices Multiply

The result has been a curious national conversation, one in which engineers, mechanics, YouTube experts, social media influencers, roadside garages and WhatsApp universities have all enthusiastically joined in. The motorist, meanwhile, continues to do what Indians do best: seek advice from everyone. Depending on whom one speaks to, ethanol is either the future of clean mobility or the beginning of the end for the internal combustion engine. One video predicts catastrophic engine failures. Another dismisses every concern as misinformation. One expert urges car-owners to embrace the future. Another recommends avoiding ethanol-blended fuel whenever



ONE FUEL PUMP. ONE NOZZLE. ONE POSER. ARE YOU READY?

As India moves towards wider adoption of E20 petrol, consumers need information, not anxiety. The first step is simple. Check whether your vehicle is E20-compatible. Most newer models are, but older vehicles may not be fully designed for prolonged use with higher ethanol blends. The problem: 20 crore of these older vehicles are still plying on India's roads.

If your manufacturer recommends E20, simply use it and continue with the prescribed maintenance schedule. If your vehicle is older, watch for noticeable drops in fuel efficiency, hard starting, rough idling or warning lights, and consult your authorized service center if problems persist. Motorbikes and scooters are more susceptible to these problems than four-wheelers.

Also remember that ethanol absorbs moisture far more readily than petrol. Vehicles that remain parked for long periods should ideally not be left with ageing fuel in the tank. Routine servicing and using fuel from reliable outlets become even more important.

The biggest precaution anyone can take is against misinformation. Social media is awash with exaggerated claims; from engines 'melting' to cars 'failing overnight'. The reality is not as dramatic. Lakhs of vehicles around the world already operate on ethanol blends without difficulty. There is a simple golden rule – know your car before your fuel.

possible. As though motorists have the luxury of choosing.

Somewhere between these competing and oscillating opinions lies the truth. Adding a new layer of intrigue is the government's own communication. Different ministries and agencies have, at different times, emphasised different aspects of the ethanol story. Energy security, environmental benefits, agricultural support, consumer awareness, vehicle compatibility. None of these objectives is inherently contradictory. Yet, viewed through the eyes of the motorist, the messaging has been fragmented, never seamless.

The consequence is not just confusion. It is uncertainty. Uncertainty

is an expensive companion for those who have invested lakhs of rupees in a vehicle expected to serve the family faithfully for a decade or more.

Consider the numbers. More than 35 crore registered vehicles, fuel sold through thousands of pumps, an ethanol blending programme touching almost every litre of petrol dispensed across the country and an auto sector that contributes 7 per cent of the GDP and supports scores of jobs. Few public policies affect so many stakeholders. That explains why a debate that began in labs and boardrooms is echoing through garages, transport unions, social media platforms and the corridors of power.

Ripple Effects

The larger anxiety has travelled beyond private car owners. Taxi operators, transporters and commercial fleet owners – whose livelihoods depend on predictable operating costs and dependable vehicles – have voiced concerns. Associations have demanded clarity, while some have spoken of organised representations and protests seeking definitive answers. Whether every fear is technically justified is beside the point. In public policy, perception travels faster than engineering explanations.

And ironically, all this is unfolding at precisely the moment when electric vehicles are beginning to gather momentum.

For some, the ethanol debate has become part of another calculation altogether. “If petrol is changing, should the next vehicle simply be electric,” they ask. That was never the intended outcome. For anybody, India's mobility future was never designed as a contest between ethanol and electric power. Both were expected to complement each other, offering different pathways towards reducing fossil fuel dependence. Yet, public uncertainty in one technology has spilt over into another, making consumer choices more complicated, not less.

Missing Ingredient

The larger lesson extends way beyond ethanol. Modern automobiles have become models of perfect science, remarkably sophisticated machines. They are engineered to comply with stringent emission norms, incorporate complex electronics and operate with specified fuels and lubricants. Any meaningful transition, whether involving fuels, emissions or electrification, requires not merely

WHAT BEGAN AS AN ENERGY-SECURITY SUCCESS STORY IS *steadily evolving* INTO A BURNING BATTLE OVER ENGINES, ECONOMICS, EXPECTATIONS AND ACCOUNTABILITY

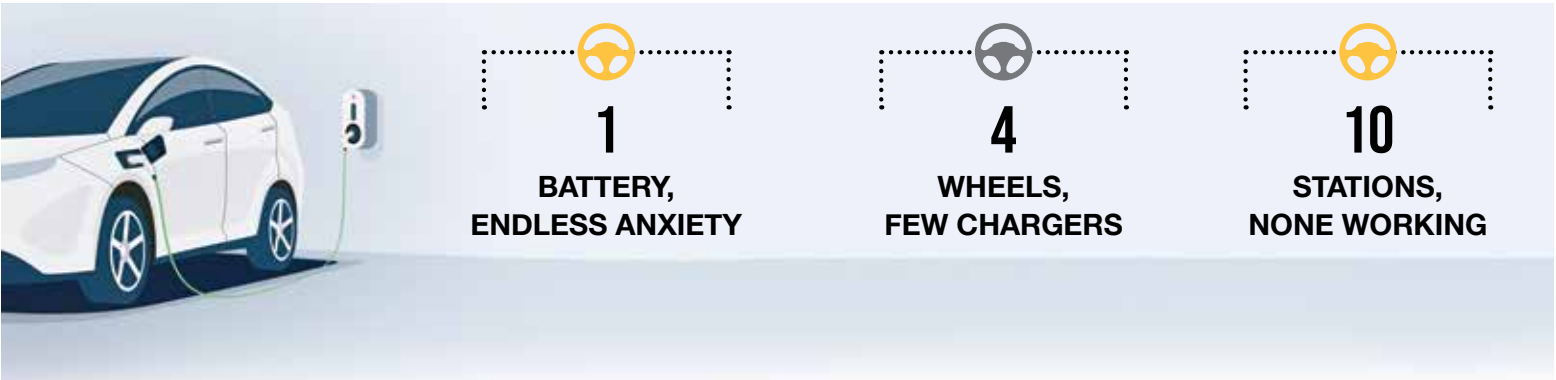
technological readiness but public confidence.

Confidence cannot be manufactured through notifications; it is nurtured through inclusion. It is grown with consistency in communication, lab testing and answers that address public concerns without dismissing them as resistant to change. India deserves credit

for pursuing energy diversification with seriousness. Reducing crude oil imports, supporting agriculture and exploring cleaner alternatives remain objectives worthy of support. The question is not whether the destination is desirable. It is whether every traveller has been given a reliable map.

That explains why the ethanol debate refuses to disappear. It is no longer about chemistry or combustion. It has become a conversation about trust. Motorists are not asking for miracles. They are asking for clarity. They want to know whether their vehicles are compatible, what precautions (if any) they should take, who bears responsibility if problems arise and how policy changes will affect vehicles already on the roads.

These are not unreasonable questions. Thus, they deserve unambiguous answers. For now, India's ethanol story continues to resemble a long highway where signboards occasionally point in different directions. The destination may still be worthwhile, but the journey has become unexpectedly complicated. And until certainty replaces speculation, crores of Indian motorists will continue doing what they have done throughout this saga... Fill up their tanks, turn the ignition key and hope that both the engine and the policy remain in sync.



Electric Dreams. Charging Nightmares

India has embraced EVs blindly. It now needs to urgently build an ecosystem that allows owners to drive their electric chariots with confidence, not crossed fingers

AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

India's car-buyer has always been an optimist. Every generation has willingly embraced change, be it the transition from carburettors to fuel injection, manual gearboxes to automatics or BS-IV to BS-VI emission norms. Today, that optimism is powering yet another revolution: Electric Mobility.

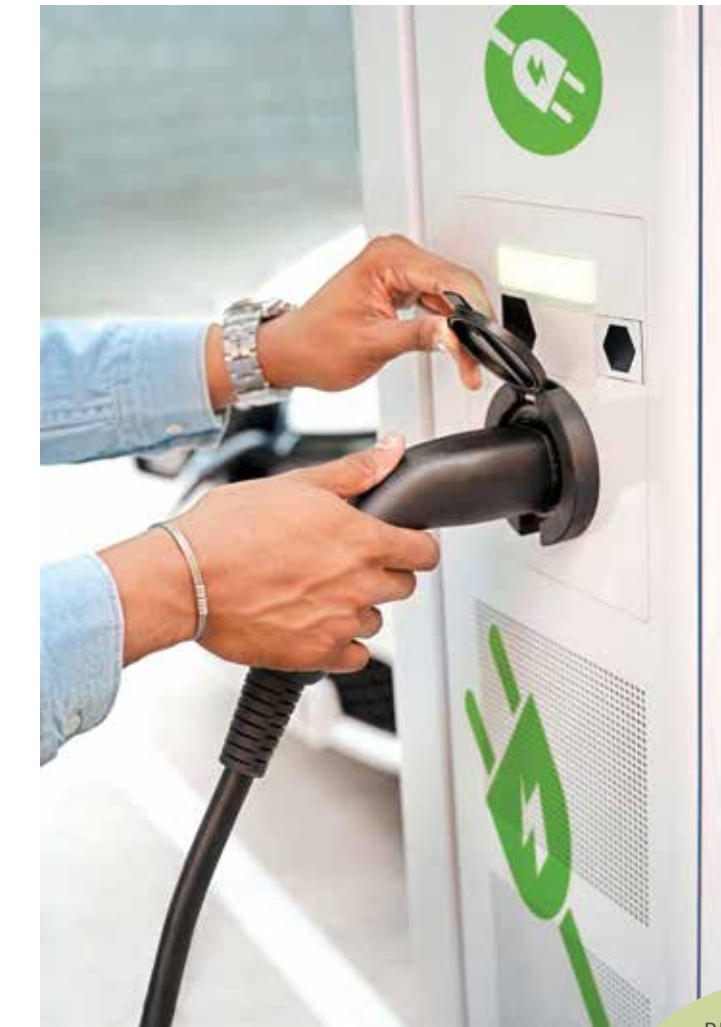
Walk into any showroom and you realize that an electric vehicle has never been easier. Auto firms have expanded their portfolios, battery ranges have improved, government incentives have nudged buyers in the right direction and charging cables now come neatly packed in bottomless boots. For wannabe buyers, especially amid continuing concerns over the compatibility of E20 fuel with internal combustion engines, an EV appears to be the logical and safe step.

Then comes the first long drive. Suddenly, the conversation is no longer about torque, touchscreen displays or driving range. It is about charger availability, charging speed, connector compatibility, payment apps and whether the next charging station would actually be working. Buying the car, it dawns on you, is the easy part. Living with it is far more adventurous.

MISSING ECOSYSTEM

To be fair, India's EV journey deserves applause. Vehicle technology has advanced at a remarkable pace. Modern electric cars are quieter, quicker and more refined than many sceptics imagined even a few years ago. Battery chemistry continues to improve, driving ranges are increasing and almost all manufacturers now consider electrification central to their future.

The problem lies elsewhere. In an India that has built an EV market faster than it has built an EV ecosystem. A conventional fuel station inspires confidence because motorists never ask whether it will be operational. They pull in, refuel in a few minutes, pay and accelerate away. Charging an electric vehicle, on



the other hand, resembles a treasure hunt. Drivers consult multiple mobile applications, compare user reviews, call charging operators, calculate battery percentages and hope that the station shown on a digital map is functional when they finally arrive. But hope is not infrastructure.

RANGE VS REALITY

The phrase 'range anxiety' has become synonymous with electric vehicles. Ironically, it no longer accurately describes the problem. Most modern EVs offer respectable driving ranges for everyday use. The real anxiety stems not from how far the car can travel, but from uncertainty about everything that follows.

Will the charging station be occupied? Will it deliver the promised fast-charging speeds or trickle electricity into the battery while daylight quietly gives way to darkness? Will the payment gateway cooperate? Is the connector compatible? Is the location well-lit and secure enough for a family

travelling after sunset?

Far too many EV owners recount stories of arriving at charging stations only to discover equipment that is out of service, painfully slow or plain inaccessible. Some describe spending hours inside parked vehicles late into the night, waiting for enough charge to continue their journey, because nearby alternatives either do not exist or cannot be relied upon.

The irony is difficult to miss. We have built vehicles capable of whisper-quiet acceleration, connected them to satellites and smartphones and equipped them with AI. Yet, a weekend drive can still hinge on whether a charging unit beside a dhaba decides to cooperate. Technology has galloped ahead. Infrastructure is trying to trot in its wake.

BEYOND THE PLUG

Charging stations cannot be viewed merely as electrical installations. They are becoming the roadside service stations of tomorrow. A petrol or diesel vehicle spends barely five minutes at a fuel pump. An EV may remain at a charger for 30 minutes, or much longer. That changes everything. Drivers need restrooms, safe parking, seating areas, cafés, convenience stores, adequate lighting and security. Families travelling with children or elderly passengers require comfort and reassurance, not uncertainty and inconvenience.

Equally important is information. Despite India's achievements in digital infrastructure, there remains no single authenticated, universally accepted repository of charging stations that provides real-time information on availability, operational status, charging speeds, connector types and payment options across operators. Instead, EV owners navigate a maze of proprietary apps, crowdsourced reviews and social media recommendations before venturing onto unfamiliar highways.

Planning a road trip should involve choosing destinations, not conducting forensic investigations into charging infrastructure.

WAY BEYOND CARS

None of this should be interpreted as an argument against electric mobility. Quite the contrary. Electric vehicles are a critical part of India's automotive future. They promise cleaner cities, lower dependence on imported fossil fuels and exciting opportunities for domestic manufacturing. Their momentum is unlikely to (and should not) be reversed.

But revolutions are not measured merely by the number of units sold. They are judged by the confidence they inspire. The true benchmark for India's EV transition will not be monthly sales figures or the number of models launched. It will be the day when a family can set out from Delhi to Jaipur, Bengaluru to Mysuru, Mumbai to Goa or Chennai to Coimbatore without checking half a dozen charging apps, calculating contingency plans or silently praying that the next charging station is operational.

The automobile industry has built cars that are ready for tomorrow. The challenge now belongs to everyone else. Governments must accelerate the creation of reliable charging networks. Charging operators must be held to standards of uptime, maintenance and transparency. Urban planners must integrate charging into future infrastructure rather than treat it as an afterthought. Technology platforms should work towards interoperable payment systems and a unified, authenticated national database of charging stations.

Electric mobility ultimately runs on batteries. But public confidence runs on certainty. Until charging an EV becomes as predictable and effortless as refuelling a conventional vehicle, India's electric revolution will remain a journey of immense promise, but one frequently interrupted by a blinking battery icon and an uncomfortable wait on the side of the highway.

BUYING AN EV IN INDIA IS BECOMING EASIER EVERY MONTH.
Driving
ONE WHEREVER YOU WANT IS A VERY DIFFERENT STORY; A TOUGH AND SOBERING STORY AT THAT

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

Even as climate and climate change have been pushed to the back burner by the Trump administration, the adverse effects of climate change are being felt worldwide: from the January 2026 forest fires in Australia to the lack of snowfall in the North Indian Himalayas. At the same time, efforts at various levels to meet the challenges posed by climate change are continuing, from more efficient battery storage to innovative ways to reduce carbon dioxide. With AI becoming an important part of our lives, it is essential that it is used in these efforts. Let us discuss this in more detail.

A RECAP OF CLIMATE CHANGE CHALLENGES

In the Climate Change series of articles, I have divided the challenges arising out of climate change into two buckets: mitigation and adaptation. I also covered a third issue: carbon dioxide reduction (CDR) as a necessary intervention if the Paris Agreement targets of limiting warming to 1.5°C/2°C are to be met. This is because mitigation alone will not be enough, even if all emissions were to cease today. There is simply too much carbon dioxide in the atmosphere, which needs to be removed and stored away or converted into harmless carbonate ions.

The mitigation issues I covered were mainly in energy (renewables such as solar and wind, smart grids, etc.), manufacturing (particularly the hard-to-abate sectors such as iron and steel, aluminium, cement and fertilisers), urban and municipal management, transport and electric mobility, and batteries. The adaptation issues were mainly in the agriculture, irrigation, forestry, coastal and marine sectors. The CDR measures discussed were carbon capture and storage, direct air capture, direct ocean capture, enhanced rock weathering and biochar. In each of these areas, AI offers huge scope to improve processes and implementation. Let us see how.

AI INTERVENTION IN MITIGATION

One of the most obvious ways in which AI can help is through better early warning systems. This is because of the superior analytical and comprehension capabilities of AI, which can grasp the complex and non-linear processes inherent in climate change. Further, AI can integrate data from various sources, such as satellites, monitoring stations and historical records, to predict extreme weather events such as floods, cyclones, heavy and erratic rainfall, etc.

In manufacturing, AI can help improve productivity by monitoring process flows and triggering alarms in the event of any deviations. It also minimises unplanned shutdowns of plants through better monitoring of machines and components, early detection of wear and tear, and recommendations for optimal spare-parts inventory. AI can also improve quality control through real-time inspection of products,

optimise inventory management, enhance plant efficiency and reduce emissions.

In the energy sector, AI can assist in the generation of both conventional thermal power and renewable energy, such as solar and wind. In thermal plants, AI can optimise combustion, enhance predictive maintenance and reduce emissions. In the case of renewable energy, where the main concern is unpredictability, AI helps improve reliability by stabilising the grid and making it smarter, thereby matching supply with demand.

In transport, AI systems can use sensors to assess traffic flow, helping optimise bus and metro routes. They can also assist in the predictive maintenance of bus fleets and metro rakes. As more and more electric vehicles populate the roads, AI systems can enable vehicles to communicate with one another, potentially preventing accidents.

AI IN ADAPTATION

AI systems can greatly help overcome challenges in urban and municipal administration. With more than half the world's population living in cities, municipal administrations are overworked and urban infrastructure is overstretched. Moreover, urban areas, with their residential and institutional buildings, concrete structures and blacktop roads, become heat islands during peak summer, particularly in Asia and Africa.



AI CAN BECOME one of the defining technologies of the global climate transition—not by replacing human decisions, but by making them smarter, faster and more effective

Similarly, drainage systems in cities are not equipped to handle the extreme rainfall that is becoming increasingly common, often leading to waterlogging and flooding, followed by the spread of diseases such as malaria and dengue. Finally, high vehicle density makes urban air heavily polluted. AI systems can help with heat mapping, stress-testing infrastructure such as bridges and high-tension transmission lines, upgrading drainage systems, optimising traffic flows, and retrofitting buildings to make them more habitable.

In the agriculture sector, climate change poses challenges such as soil erosion due to extreme and erratic rainfall, increasing pest attacks, and altered growing seasons caused by rising temperatures and more frequent hot days. AI systems can assist with precision irrigation, soil health monitoring and the development of climate-resilient seeds.

CONCLUSION

AI is all the rage today, with countries competing to build AI infrastructure across sectors. The original large language models and machine learning systems, such as ChatGPT, have now evolved into applications across virtually every field. AI systems can also play a major role in supporting our mitigation and adaptation efforts, as discussed above.



AI will not replace climate action, but it can make mitigation, adaptation and carbon removal far more effective



Making of a Global India

Anil K. Antony's Advantage India argues that India's rise is rooted not merely in economic growth or geopolitical opportunity, but in civilisational resilience, technological innovation and an ambition to shape a more equitable global order

AUTHOR



NEHA SINGH

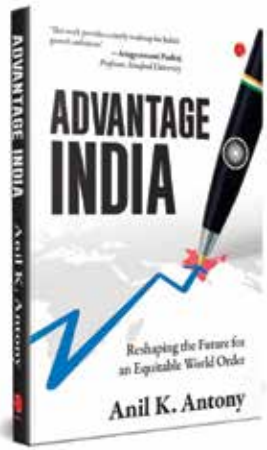
There is a Sanskrit idea that civilisations do not rise by accident. They rise because, at a particular point in history, intention and effort converge. There are very few books that do not merely inform you but reorient you. You begin reading something with a set of assumptions and prejudices about the world and you finish it with a quiet unease in your heart that those assumptions were way too small. *Advantage India: Reshaping the Future for an Equitable World Order* by Anil K. Antony is that kind of book. And at a time when headlines come faster than the world can make sense of them, the book arrives at exactly the right time.

The title itself carries a provocation. *Advantage India* is not a declaration of victory but rather a question which is dressed as a statement. And the pleasure of reading this book is that Antony answers this question patiently, page by page. What is India's real advantage? Where does it come from and, most importantly, what must India do to confirm it? It does not dissipate something history rarely offers any civilisation - a genuine opening.

These are some of the very uncomfortable questions that the author answers very strategically. What the author offers is something very valuable: a framework for understanding a country that is in the middle of becoming something that it has never been quite before.

Winston Churchill once doubted with dismissiveness that India could ever truly be a nation. Antony returns to this dismissiveness not to settle scores but to raise much more interesting questions about what India's democratic endurance over seven decades actually tells us about the civilisation. His answers are one of the most compelling passages of the book. He argues India's resilience is not just a product of the twentieth century but of civilisational memory that has always known how to absorb change without losing itself, which has been described by the author as a strategic asset. It is this same civilisational fluidity that allows India today to sit with the Quad and BRICS in the same breath, to partner with Israel and Iran, to speak for the Global South while negotiating with the Global North not as contradiction, but as character.

The book moves across terrains as wide as India itself. From the choices India made after the traumatic independence to the cutthroat



competition in semiconductors, AI, space, clean energy, defence and the architecture of a new world order that the whole world is competing over. The author highlights how a country that has spent decades as a consumer of technology is making serious headlines in becoming a producer and innovator of the same. He examines India's digital infrastructure that has transformed how millions of Indians

access money, identity, healthcare and commerce, becoming a model for the rest of the world that not only studies it but replicates it. And beyond its borders, India is helping build coalitions the world had not seen before. The International Solar Alliance, the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure, the Global Biofuels Alliance frameworks are among the many frameworks that carry India's strategic fingerprint while addressing problems that belong to everyone. Closer home, he looks at India's defence transformation as the emergence of a doctrine backed by an industrial ecosystem and not on import dependencies. He also looks at energy and India's green transition, which has moved faster than almost anyone predicted. The author asks what it means for a country of India's size to have sovereignty over its own power, something it has never had before.

What makes all these vast sections stay with you is not the data and information but the intricate arterial network the author has built across the narrative, carrying a common pulse from one chapter to another and making every theme feel indispensable to the larger

whole. Technology policy is also security policy, energy sovereignty is also economic sovereignty, the demographic dividend means nothing without the institutions to absorb them, the inclusion of women who have stood at the edge of the economy for far too long. All these connections are intentional, yet not obvious is one of the book's quiet achievements.

But what touches you the most is not the arguments and facts Antony gives, but rather the quality of attention he gives to the human beings of this story. The women who are quietly building enterprises in communities that are far from headlines, the young Indians who will inherit a future more complex and competitive than ever, the farmers navigating risk in an agrarian economy that the country depends upon but is still overlooked. There is tenderness and care in how Antony holds these lives together alongside the strategies and facts of the book, reminding us the purpose of national power is not just power itself but

the people it is meant to serve.

He also addresses the vulnerabilities and gaps that persist. The distance India is yet to cover is acknowledged without a flinch. And yet *Advantage India* is an act of optimism. Optimism that does not overlook the difficult things but rather looks directly in the eyes and concludes India has what it takes to navigate them.

There comes a moment in the middle of the book when you begin to see what the author is really building. It is not just a story of India's ambitions, but of the historic moment in which those ambitions are taking shape. The world order that governed the last eight decades is under strain; new powers are rising; old certainties are dissolving and in the middle of all this has risen a civilisation of 1.4 billion people that is asking questions while asserting its role in whatever comes next.

The author does not answer any questions for you but gives you everything you need to answer them yourself. By the time you turn the end pages, the subtitle of the book, "equitable world order," becomes self-explanatory.

ADVANTAGE INDIA PRESENTS A SWEEPING ACCOUNT OF INDIA'S EMERGENCE AS A CONSEQUENTIAL GLOBAL POWER

It remains no longer a diplomatic language but a wager India is putting on itself to build a world that is fairer than the one it inherited.

Churchill and many others thought India would never find its voice. *Advantage India* is the answer, with records of fact, figures and stories proving how wrong he and the others were.

Whether you are a student trying to make sense of the world you are inheriting, a practitioner navigating the new geopolitics of technology and trade, or simply a reader who believes that ideas about nations and power and justice are worth taking seriously, this book deserves a place in your hands.

It is the kind of book that refuses to end with its final page. Long after it has been set aside, its questions continue to echo, quietly reshaping the way one sees India and its future.

In many ways, the journey that *Advantage India* envisions echoes an enduring Upanishadic call:

उत्तिष्ठत जाग्रत प्राप्य वरि नबोधत।
Uttisthata jāgrata prāpya varān nibodhata.
(Arise. Awake. Approach the wise and realise the highest.)
— **Katha Upanisad (1.3.14)**

The Many Lives We Live

Amrita Mahale's novel blends wildlife biology, artificial intelligence, feminism and philosophy into an expansive meditation on identity, choice and the many selves we inhabit

AUTHOR



YAUVANIKA CHOPRA

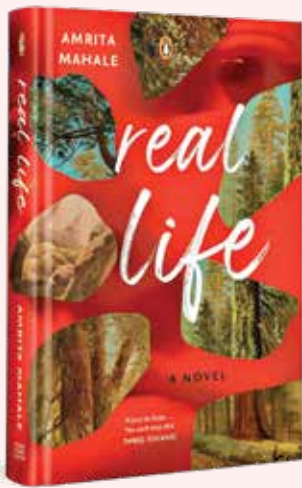
Every time we have a choice to make, the universe splits into two, or more, to allow for the possibilities of our different paths. All these different worlds exist in parallel, densely packed, each oblivious to the existence of the other. In this universe, a butterfly could flap its wings in Brazil and stir a tornado in Texas; in another, the atmospheric diamonds of Saturn might freeze into glaciers on Earth. In one obnoxious universe, there are no humans. Perhaps in a fourth, more obliging possibility, we live simultaneously in the times of the insects and the times of the stars.

Tara Kumar had been obsessed with parallel universes in the quicksilver curiosity of her youth. A little earlier, the focus of her attention had been hybrid animals like mules. A little later, she shifted to musing over the inexplicable mysteries of evolution. Ultimately, these ripples would swirl into the inevitable choice

of becoming a wildlife biologist, a "relentless paparazzo" to endangered Himalayan dogs called dholes, gathering scatological samples to decode migration patterns. Tara had known early on, since her first splitting headache as a child, that she would have a strange life: "Many people, she thinks, would see it as an illness of the spirit. It is hard to say where it comes from, the conviction that leads some women to believe that they can do something wildly different from what society has ordained for them."

Her real-life friend, Mansi Deshmukh, is more ordinary than the radical sorority of unwell, young, famous women whose biographies Tara pored over—poets and scientists who had taken the chance to apply themselves fully to the pursuit of truth and beauty. Mansi's teenage fantasy was to study abroad because she wanted to flip burgers for pocket money at fast-food restaurants like the heroines of American sitcoms and comics. "How perfect," Tara had cruelly replied to this confession of a derivative dream. "The working-class life without the taint of caste." It had stung to hear an insult from a best friend, but Mansi is honest about her dishonesty as a narrator. "There is inside me a kind of blindness that lets me look past the things I do not know, that I do not care to know. It makes me see but not understand, hear but not listen. In other words, I was raised to never be a difficult woman."

Thus, Mansi marries a handsome young man with affectionate parents



AMRITA CRAFTS A DEEPLY PHILOSOPHICAL NOVEL THAT ASKS WHETHER OUR GREATEST transformations EMERGE NOT FROM CERTAINTY, BUT FROM THE FRACTURES THAT FORCE US TO REIMAGINE OURSELVES

(whose affection is reserved for their handsome young son) and spends her days working to improve the efficacy of India's third-most-popular fairness

cream, while Tara earns a PhD in her quest to understand the behavioural tendencies of elusive-yet-friendly dholes and wanders across mountains under a relentlessly bright sun. Between them is "Romeo" Bhaskar, a machine-learning engineer who believes in the potential of artificial intelligence to alleviate human suffering despite his awareness of the fundamental truth that human existence is far from unidimensional.

"Am I one person with everyone I talk to? There is a camaraderie I share with my college friends," thinks Bhaskar to himself. "For my mother, I reserve an adoring but playful tone, and when I speak to my father, a vulnerable formality creeps into my voice. You could think of this as the many masks a single person wears in his interactions with the world, but whichever way you put it, real people are many people in one, and yet there is always a single light animating all these moving shadows." What if these shadows could be integrated through AI? Could generating optimized textual analysis reproduce anima? Perhaps in one universe, code performs the syntax of sentence so convincingly that speech, silence, and soul become unnecessary.

His real-life work at a lab in the Bay Area had enabled extraordinary experiments aimed at compressing character patterns into chatbots—large language models that extract from the environment for the convenience of humans. Bhaskar knows that personal biases can

be encoded into software but has no friend to hold a mirror to the delusions that corrupt his sincere desire to serve a greater purpose. "Techno-solutionism can easily become the mindless pursuit of efficiency," Tara had suggested to him once. Bhaskar dislikes the antiseptic curation of modern life but is less transparent to himself than Mansi about his own hypocrisies. "It did not matter what he wanted; he had come to understand that the world did not operate that way... And yet, he liked people to think that he alone steered the ship of his life."

There is surveillance, and perception, and the real self blinking through them whenever possible in Amrita Mahale's ambitious and remarkably insightful second novel. The intricacies of ethology and ethical AI dance through her lyrical prose as the book uncovers layers of complexity behind cursory stereotypes of a shrinking girl, a lonely boy, and a wild woman.

The stories of Mansi, Bhaskar, and Tara are a meditation on the importance of questioning stories—especially those we know best, because the most dangerous lies are the ones we tell ourselves. We begin by believing in our magnificence, then realise the cracks in that belief, and fix the fissures as best we can. But it is precisely in these breaks that evolution accelerates because that is when life is presented with new opportunities and new necessities.

"Mountains," Tara knows, "remain

a work in progress forever, and nature keeps a ledger of all changes. As wind and rain chisel away at the cliffs, as erosion cuts open entire chunks, the story of the mountains' birth is made visible: layers of geological history thrust through one another like two halves of a pack of cards shuffled together. One tends to think of the earth as a gentle and pitiful mother, but here in the mountains, she is witness to the earth's enormous and terrifying power." In the fictional Mahamaya Valley (whose scenic beauty and plastic pollution evoke the awful paradox of Uttarakhand), it is easy to imagine a multiverse in which one possibility could be a root that survives the most ruthless seasons by going deep beneath the frost, a root that "drinks first from snow and then from spring. It bursts forth. Like a fairytale beanstalk, it grows, and it reaches beyond the realm of giants, beyond the clouds, beyond the grasp of the earth itself. All the way to the stars."

From Amrita Mahale to Adrienne Rich's poem *Planetarium* (dedicated to astronomer Caroline Herschel and featuring a line from her memoirs), there could be "a woman 'in the snow / among the clocks and instruments / or measuring the ground with poles.'" There are other galaxies of women doing penance for their impetuosity, and what we see is how we change: "I am an instrument in the shape / of a woman trying to translate pulsations / into images for the relief of the body / and the reconstruction of the mind."

From Glasgow to Ahmedabad



India's successful CWG campaign is only the beginning. As Glasgow hands over the baton to Ahmedabad, the focus shifts from winning medals to building a clean, confident and globally respected sporting nation

AUTHOR



S KANNAN

From Glasgow to Ahmedabad, that could well be the theme for the Commonwealth Games. As the curtain comes down on the 2026 edition of the compact Games tonight, it will be more than symbolic. A new journey begins.

First, the highs from chilly Glasgow, where the Indian athletes, able-bodied and Para, have done well to win medals and catch the attention of one and all. Participation in multi-discipline Games is no longer just symbolic for India. Today's Indian athletes win medals and deliver strong performances. For those who say the standards in the CWG are low, no, that is wrong. As PT Usha, the President of the Indian Olympic Association, told this writer, winning medals in athletics is a big deal. For each winner, from Gulveer to Murali Sreeshankar and Seema, what they did in the athletics arena is defining.

At the same time, the kind of resilience shown by Tejaswin Shankar in the decathlon tells you how, despite a knee injury, an Indian will still push hard, stay fit and go through 10 events in a gruelling competition. This kind of spirit and passion will set an example for so many athletes in the coming days, weeks and years.

When Team India landed in Glasgow, there was apprehension about how many medals would be won. Today, despite the total number of disciplines being reduced

to just 10 in Glasgow, the performances are still something to write home about. Indian weightlifting, which has again been caught in doping controversies at home, has won medals in large numbers. In legend Mirabai Chanu, India has a role model who has inspired so many new weightlifters. They look up to her for inspiration. Mira's journey is important, having won three gold medals in three editions of the CWG, and for the way she has battled injuries and fitness issues. By nature, the sport of weightlifting is hard on the body, and performances boil down to one day. That is what peaking is about, as India showed.

Then again, Indian boxing today has important faces, both men and women. Winning medals is important, but the emergence of new talent and the way the pugilists compete against foreigners is an eye-opener. At least at the CWG, competing hard against boxers from Commonwealth nations is proof of that killer instinct. England, Scotland and countries such as Nigeria and Zambia have strong boxers in the field.

Where India needs to work hard is in gymnastics, where too many competitions and injuries have hit the competitors hard. Of course, the journey will continue next at the Asian Games in Nagoya, Japan. The same goes for the Indian swimmers, where Srihari Nataraj and Sajan Prakash showed they can try hard. If medals have eluded them, it is no shame.

It is heartening to hear overseas media speak positively about India when its athletes compete on the field of play. That fearless streak, the desire to showcase mental strength and the determination to raise the bar define India in sports. For a nation where cricket still comes first, performances at the CWG are like a stepping stone. The next level where the Indians have to deliver is the Asian Games, where competition standards are much higher. In just about two years, India will also be competing

INDIA IS NO LONGER JUST A HOST. INDIA competes FIERCELY, AND THE JOURNEY TO AHMEDABAD AND BEYOND HAS ALREADY BEGUN

at the 2028 Olympics in Los Angeles.

That is the pinnacle, for an Olympic medal is the ultimate. Can Neeraj Chopra go for one more medal with his famous javelin, people ask. Neeraj has been a modest athlete and trains hard. He avoids all distractions, and his humility makes him a darling. It is important for a star athlete to be seen as a role model. As Indians, we need to realise it is not just the cricketers who charm the world with their performances. Neeraj Chopra is the biggest star India has in the Olympic arena, the Asian Games arena and also the Commonwealth Games arena. He commands respect, and medals alone cannot define his aura and presence every time.

A word about the organisers in Glasgow. They did well to put on a show despite having less time to prepare. The delivery of the Commonwealth Games was efficient and spectator-friendly. For most sporting events to be held in the main city is a big plus. The swimming and athletics arenas were slightly distanced, but connectivity was good.

Where the organisers showed presence of mind was in capping costs. Instead of splurging money on building an Athletes' Village, they secured four main hotels and used them to accommodate the athletes. The food

menu was defining, for even those who relied on a completely vegetarian diet were more than satisfied. Opulence was missing, but not energy. This could well be the way forward, as hosting the Games is not easy at all.

So, what happens tonight at the closing ceremony? It is a proud moment as the handover ceremony takes place, where Dr PT Usha and Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghvi will take charge. The city of Ahmedabad is certainly excited about the next CWG. Work has already started, and the buzz is about the next edition. As I have spent a fortnight in Glasgow, the questions asked about Ahmedabad, its culture and the energy it will provide have been many.

Many functions have already been held in Glasgow, and the Indian diaspora has been engaged in various activities. How India can keep the Commonwealth sports movement going forward has become important. The city of Ahmedabad has already hosted major cricket events at the Narendra Modi Stadium. The Coldplay concert, also held in Ahmedabad, is proof of how vibrant Gujarat is today. So many international events have already been hosted in the capital of Gujarat, and this could well become the next great sporting destination. That narrative is a positive one, where ambience, efficiency in organisation and hands-on involvement will be defining. The Organising Committee has to be formed, and India will definitely host a big Games where more disciplines will be included.

The big worry for India is how to handle the doping menace at home. This is one area where India has to work hard and educate athletes. Doping is a shame and cannot be tolerated. Be it weightlifting, judo or even rowing, the doping-positive cases involving Indian athletes have been disturbing. The Government of India is not going to tolerate doping. Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, who was present at the opening ceremony in Glasgow, said strongly that doping cheats will not be spared. The larger picture is identifying the National Sports Federations that are lax and also identifying the supply chain of banned drugs.

India wishes to host the 2036 Olympics as well, and it is a realistic dream. Ahmedabad has been showcased as a beautiful city, and the development that has taken place there has been noticed by the world. I got queries from the British media as well about how Ahmedabad would be different. I have said that seeing is believing, and they must come to the host city and see for themselves how planning has begun.

Indeed, the narrative has changed. India is no longer just a host. India, or Bharat, competes fiercely in the sporting arena. Clean sport is the way forward, as new athletes will capture the ethos and pathos of India. The journey over the next four years has already begun.

Jai Hind.

WELLNESS

THE PROCRASTINATION TRAP



It's not laziness. It's how the brain responds to fear, uncertainty and discomfort. Understanding why we procrastinate is the first step towards changing the habit

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

“Dear Doctor, I've always been a procrastinator. Every time I sit down to work, I somehow end up doing something else that feels more interesting but is far less important. I know it's hurting my work, but I keep repeating the same pattern. Why do I do this? Am I just lazy? How can I stop?”

If this sounds familiar, you're far from alone. Procrastination is one of the most common struggles I hear about in my clinic. The biggest myth is that procrastinators are lazy. In reality, procrastination is less about poor time management and more about how our brain manages uncomfortable emotions.

When a task feels stressful, boring, overwhelming or uncertain, the brain looks for immediate relief. So, instead of starting that presentation, assignment or tax return, we scroll social media, reorganise our desk or watch “just one” video. It feels good in the moment, but the relief is temporary. The work is still waiting, often with added guilt.

THE TOP FIVE REASONS PEOPLE PROCRASTINATE

- 1. FEAR OF FAILURE**
Sometimes, we delay because we're afraid we won't do the task well enough. Ironically, not starting feels safer than risking failure.
- 2. PERFECTIONISM**
Many people don't procrastinate because they don't care. They procrastinate because they care too much. If something can't be done perfectly, they struggle to begin.
- 3. FEELING OVERWHELMED**
A large project can feel mentally exhausting before you've even started. When the task feels too big, the brain simply avoids it.
- 4. INSTANT GRATIFICATION**
Our brains are wired to choose immediate rewards over distant ones. Checking your phone gives you a dopamine hit now. Completing a project may not pay off for weeks.

5. UNDERLYING MENTAL HEALTH CONDITIONS
Persistent procrastination can sometimes be a symptom of conditions such as ADHD, anxiety or depression. Difficulty concentrating, fear of making mistakes or low motivation can all make starting tasks much harder.

- The good news is that procrastination is a habit, and habits can be changed.
- Start by making tasks smaller. Instead of saying, “I have to finish the report,” tell yourself, “I'll work for just five minutes.” Starting is often the biggest hurdle.
 - Break big projects into manageable steps. A page feels easier than a chapter.
 - Use a timer. The 25-minute work, 5-minute break technique helps many people stay focused without feeling overwhelmed.
 - Remove distractions before you begin. Put your phone away, close unnecessary tabs and make it easier to focus than to drift.

SELF-CRITICISM fuels procrastination. Self-compassion breaks the cycle

Most importantly, stop waiting until you “feel motivated.” Motivation usually follows action, not the other way around. The hardest part is often simply beginning.

BIG DON'T

One mistake many procrastinators make is being relentlessly self-critical. The cycle becomes predictable: delay the task, feel guilty, call yourself lazy, feel worse, delay even more. Self-criticism fuels procrastination. Self-compassion breaks the cycle. Accept that today didn't go as planned, then restart tomorrow without carrying yesterday's guilt.

WORD OF CAUTION

If procrastination has been lifelong or is affecting your work, studies or relationships, don't dismiss it as a personality flaw. A mental health assessment can help identify whether ADHD, anxiety, depression or another issue is contributing to the problem.

Remember, successful people don't necessarily have more motivation. They have better systems for getting started. The goal isn't perfection; instead, it's learning to take the first step, even when you don't feel like it.

BOOK RECOMMENDATIONS

Atomic Habits
by James Clear;
Feel Good Productivity
by Ali Abdaal.



'More things can happen CAREER-WISE'

Tillotama Shome said there was a time in her career when she would not know when she would get her next movie

Tillotama Shome said there was a time in her career when she would not know when she would get her next movie, but it all changed with the success of projects like 'Sir', which introduced her to a new set of audiences.

Shome is regarded as one of the most versatile performers in the industry, known for her wide-ranging work in projects such as 'Qissa', 'Sir', 'Lust Stories 2', 'Delhi Crime 2', 'Pataal Lok 2', 'The Night Manager' and the recently released film 'Ikka' co-starring Sunny Deol and Akshaye Khanna.

"I think more things can happen career-wise; I've the capacity to take more. But what is new is that earlier in my career, when one film was coming out, I didn't know what I was going to do next. That has changed. I've a lot more work," Shome told PTI in an interview.

The actress expressed gratitude to filmmakers for being willing to cast her in diverse roles.

"There are many directors who have bet on me and trusted me with something, even though I've not played a part like that before. So, these are the new things that perhaps didn't happen five-ten years ago in my career," she said.

Shome said her biggest hope is to continue earning the trust of both audiences and filmmakers through her work. "I hope to work with new directors; they trust me and I don't betray their trust. I don't get lazy; I get opportunities that challenge me. I don't give in to inertia or boredom. I stay open and flexible."

Shome made her acting debut in 2001 with 'Monsoon Wedding', directed by Mira Nair, but said the film's success didn't immediately translate into opportunities for her. She moved to New York for a master's program in educational theatre at New York University for four years.

"I didn't think I would come back to acting. But after I came back here, I realised, 'Oh, it's not so easy to act in a film. It's hard to get work.' But it's a very saturated industry; it's competitive and all those things that you hear are also true," the actress recalled.

Shome added, "The real challenge began when I became a full-time actor. There were

many dark days, days where I couldn't believe in myself. But luckily, I had people who believed in me."

She then featured in films like Dibakar Banerjee's 'Shang-hai', 'Qissa' with Irrfan Khan, Manoj Bajpayee-starrer, 'Budhia Singh: Born to Run', Konkana Sen Sharma-directed, 'A Death in the Gunj', 'Hindi Medium', Rohena Gera's 'Sir' and many others.

The 47-year-old actress said each project has shaped her as an actor. However, it was 'Sir' that marked a turning point in her career. She played the lead role of Ratna, a young, determined widow who works as a domestic worker.

"The film reached a pan-India audience that



SHE IS REGARDED AS ONE OF THE MOST VERSATILE PERFORMERS IN THE INDUSTRY, KNOWN FOR HER WIDE-RANGING WORK IN SEVERAL PROJECTS



had not experienced my work and that changed in terms of directors being able to push forward my name, who knew my work from 'Monsoon Wedding,'" she said, adding that producers now saw her as a familiar pan-Indian face.

Several of her streaming projects, including 'Delhi Crime 2', 'Pataal Lok 2' and others, came after the film's success. Shome

was last seen in 'Ikka,' by director Siddharth Malhotra, alongside actors Sunny Deol and Akshaye Khanna.

The actress said she initially thought it was a prank call when Malhotra called to offer her a role in the movie. "I had not done a film of this kind. The grammar was new to me; it had a certain taste and energy, which was all very exciting for me to try," she said.

The actress praised Deol, describing him as a 'generous co-actor', who is shy and yet warm. Recounting her first interaction with Deol, Shome said she was struck by his silver shoes when he arrived on set. She was curious to know where they were from and, after being introduced to him by Malhotra, her first question to him was about those shoes.

Shome said that during the shoot, Deol was going through a difficult time as his father, the late Dharmendra, was unwell. "There was that vulnerability and he was still showing up at work. It was quite a lesson watching him being so open about the fact that they are very emotional men, who don't shy away from crying and expressing their emotions while they play such larger-than-life action heroes," she said.

Shome is now looking forward to starting a feature by the end of the month. "It's a horror genre and I haven't done that before, so I'm excited," she said. PTI

FROM SANDEEP BHAIYA TO GYANESHWAR TRIPATHI

IMPERFECT MENTORS WHO TAUGHT US THE BIGGEST LESSONS

The latest addition to this memorable league is Kay Kay Menon's Gyaneshwar Tripathi from 'Adarsh Baal Vidyalaya'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Guru Purnima is a celebration of people who shape our lives, not because they are perfect, but because they leave us with lessons that stay with us forever. Over the years, Indian streaming has introduced audiences to unforgettable teachers, mentors, visionaries and guiding figures who have inspired us in different ways. Whether helping students navigate the pressures of competitive exams, leading with empathy, nurturing innovation or encouraging people to dream bigger, these characters have gone beyond their professions to become fan favourites, leaving a lasting impact on viewers.

The latest addition to this memorable league is Kay Kay Menon's Gyaneshwar Tripathi from Prime Video's 'Adarsh Baal Vidyalaya'. As the heartfelt comedy-drama continues to win audiences over, Tripathi joins a growing list of characters who have shown us that the best teachers aren't necessarily flawless.

From classrooms and coaching centres to boardrooms and government schools, these on-screen mentors have inspired audiences with lessons that continue to resonate long after the credits roll.

KAY KAY MENON AS GYANESHWAR TRIPATHI

The newest mentor to win audiences' hearts is Menon's Gyaneshwar Tripathi from 'Adarsh Baal Vidyalaya', who is far from the conventional educator. A laidback yet deeply empathetic headmaster, Tripathi is flawed, funny and often caught between self-interest and doing what is right, making him all the more human. Through his wit, compassion and unconventional approach to leadership, he gradually earns the trust of his students and colleagues alike. Since the series premiered, audiences have embraced Gyaneshwar Tripathi for his relatable imperfections and heartfelt approach, making him a memorable addition to the ever-growing list of fan-favourite teachers on screen.



SUNNY HINDUJA AS SANDEEP BHAIYA



Before he got a show of his own, Sunny Hinduja's Sandeep Bhaiya quietly emerged as one of the most loved characters in 'Aspirants'. His reassuring presence, practical advice and unwavering support for UPSC aspirants made him much more than a senior. He became the mentor everyone wished for as they navigated one of the most challenging phases of their lives. The overwhelming love for the character eventually led to 'Sandeep Bhaiya'. This spin-off placed his journey at the centre, proving just how deeply audiences had connected with the character and the lessons he brought.

Whether helping students navigate the pressures of competitive exams, leading with empathy, nurturing innovation or encouraging people to dream bigger, these characters have gone beyond their professions to become fan favourites, leaving a lasting impact on viewers

NASEERUDDIN SHAH AS JRD TATA

In 'Made in India: A Titan Story', Naseeruddin Shah's portrayal of JRD Tata goes beyond that of an industrialist; he embodies the qualities of a true mentor. With his quiet wisdom, unwavering belief in people and ability to inspire those around him, JRD becomes the guiding force behind a generation of dreamers and innovators. Through his leadership, the series reminds viewers that the greatest mentors don't just build successful businesses; they build people, nurture potential and inspire others to believe that impossible ideas can become reality. It's these timeless lessons on vision, integrity and perseverance that make his character one of the most inspiring mentor figures on screen.



AHSAAS CHANNA AS ARCHI



More than just a story about one of India's toughest professional exams, 'Half CA' is a heartfelt coming-of-age drama that celebrates learning beyond the classroom. Through Archi's journey, the series explores how perseverance, resilience, friendships and self-belief become some of life's greatest teachers. As she navigates the pressures of becoming a Chartered Accountant while finding her own purpose, Archi reminds viewers that true education isn't only about passing an exam - it's about embracing failures, growing through challenges and discovering who you are along the way. In doing so, 'Half CA' beautifully highlights that some of the most valuable lessons come not just from mentors, but from the journey itself.

VIKRANT MASSEY SAYS HE ISN'T AFRAID OF FAILURE

The fear of creative repetition worries him more than the failure of his movies



Vikrant Massey said the fear of creative repetition worries him more than the failure of his movies, which is why he is constantly trying to reinvent himself in his movie roles. The actor, widely recognised for his critically acclaimed roles in films and OTT series such as '12th Fail', 'Sector 36', 'Haseen Dillruba', 'Dil Dhadakne Do', 'Lootera', 'Pritam and Pedro', 'Broken but Beautiful', said box office success is also important, but actors worry more about 'redundancy' and 'repetition'.

"It's not ok if a film doesn't work. You want to make money and have more people to watch it. However, in pre-sales, you recover your minimal cost. Of course, you want your film to do those numbers, but what's far scarier is redundancy as an actor: that you are doing the same thing," the actor told PTI in an interview.

He added, "So, redundancy, repetition that is something that is almost scary. I'm not scared of failing because when you do things on a trial-and-error basis, it has to happen."

Massey took a seven-month break from work in 2024 after feeling that he was becoming repetitive, and he said he used this time to revisit his own performances.

He took a seven-month break from work in 2024 after feeling that he was becoming repetitive

"I watched all my films, some at least two to three times, to rework things and it's very important to do so. The world is moving at such an unprecedented pace... So, as a creative artist, you have to keep upgrading yourself."

The 39-year-old actor's current release is his OTT series, 'Musafir Café' on 'Netflix', which marks his debut as a producer. He is also working on the biopic on spiritual guru Sri Sri Ravi Shankar tentatively titled 'White', 'Yaar Jigri' with actor Sunny Singh of 'Sonu Ke Titu Ki Sweeti' fame and others.

Despite being advised to stick to a certain image following his National Award win, Massey said he prefers to take risks and choose stories across formats. He won the top honour at the 71st National Film Awards for his performance in '12th Fail'.

"I won't lie, I always wanted to shoulder films, to play meatier parts, to drive the story. When I'm getting those opportunities, I'm very happy about it. A lot of people told me, 'You are a national award winner. You have

become a box office actor; you should not come on OTT (referring to his OTT series)," Massey said.

He added, "Also, when I did 'Sector 36', a lot of people told me not to do it (playing a negative role) because after Manoj Kumar Sharma, people only want to see your 'positive image', but I've always gone against the grain."

Massey said his aim is not just to entertain but also to create meaningful impact through his work. "My primary aim right now as a storyteller is to go out there, reach out to people, to be the voice for the voiceless; besides entertaining, I would like to give something more which is worthwhile," he said.

He credited his experience on '12th Fail' with filmmaker Vidhu Vinod Chopra for broadening his perspective on cinema, which eventually led him to explore production with 'Musafir Café'.

"I wanted to do something beyond acting because I felt that I could contribute a lot more and 'Musafir Café' felt like the right fit," he said. Set against the backdrop of Bhopal and Mussoorie, "Musafir Café" is based on a book of the same name by author Divya Prakash Dubey. 'Musafir Café' follows the intertwined journeys of three strangers as they navigate love, longing and self-discovery and stars Massey as Chander Mohan Sharma, a man searching for a life that truly feels like his own. PTI